

Prague University of Economics and Business
Faculty of Informatics and Statistics



**THE PSYCHOLOGY OF BRANDING: DEVELOPING AND
TESTING VISUAL IDENTITIES FOR A SELF-PORTRAIT
STUDIO**

BACHELOR THESIS

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Abstract

In today's visually saturated market, a brand's success may depend on how effectively its visual identity captures attention and builds trust. This bachelor thesis explores whether a visual identity developed using psychological principles — such as color psychology, emotionally resonant typography, and logo design followed by Gestalt principles — leads to improved brand perception and engagement. The main objective of this thesis is to quantitatively assess the impact of psychology-based visual identity on brand recall, emotional response, and social media interaction. Based on the research findings, a practical framework was made, offering guidelines for businesses on how to apply psychological principles if they want to create or change a visual identity. The research was guided by five questions focused on memorability, logo perception, emotional response to main visual identity components, engagement in Instagram ads, and emotional connection.

Two different visual identities were created for a modern self-portrait studio called Narcis Studio — the first one was made with the implementation of psychological theory, and the second one did not follow these principles. Their performance was evaluated through a 15-day A/B testing campaign on Instagram, with an equal ad budget of 1,725 CZK for each version, and a structured questionnaire completed by 93 respondents aged 18–34. The psychology-based identity consistently outperformed the alternative: it was perceived as more trustworthy, memorable, and emotionally engaging, and it had significantly higher engagement on Instagram. These findings confirm the importance of psychology-informed branding and form the basis of a practical guide for companies that want to have emotionally effective visual identities.

Keywords

Visual identity, branding, psychology, design, A/B testing, social media, self-portrait studio

Abstract

Na dnešním vizuálně přesyceném trhu může úspěch značky záviset na tom, jak efektivně její vizuální identita upoutá pozornost a buduje důvěru. Tato bakalářská práce zkoumá, zda vizuální identita vytvořená na základě psychologických principů – jako je psychologie barev, typografie vyvolávající emoční odezvu a návrh loga podle Gestalt principů – vede k lepšímu vnímání značky a vyššímu zapojení publika. Hlavním cílem této práce je kvantitativně posoudit vliv vizuální identity založené na psychologii na zapamatovatelnost značky, emoční reakci a interakci na sociálních sítích. Na základě výsledků byl vytvořen praktický rámec, který firmám nabízí doporučení, jak tyto psychologické principy využít při tvorbě nebo úpravě své vizuální identity. Výzkum se opírá o pět výzkumných otázek zaměřených na zapamatovatelnost, vnímání loga, emoční odezvu na hlavní vizuální prvky, zapojení v reklamách na Instagramu a emocionální propojení se značkou.

Pro moderní self-portrait studio s názvem Narcis Studio byly vytvořeny dvě odlišné vizuální identity – první vycházející z psychologických teorií a druhá bez jejich využití. Jejich účinnost byla hodnocena během 15denní kampaně A/B testování na Instagramu s rovným reklamním rozpočtem 1 725 Kč na každou variantu a pomocí strukturovaného dotazníku, který vyplnilo 93 respondentů ve věku 18–34 let. Psychologicky založená identita výrazně překonala alternativu – byla vnímána jako důvěryhodnější, zapamatovatelnější a emocionálně přitažlivější a vykazovala výrazně vyšší míru zapojení na Instagramu. Tato zjištění potvrzují význam brandingů založeného na psychologii a tvoří základ pro praktický návod pro firmy, které chtějí vytvořit vizuální identitu s emocionálním dopadem.

Keywords

Vizuální identita, branding, psychologie, design, A/B testování, sociální media, atelier autoportretu

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Introduction

Branding is an important component of a company's success, which influences consumer perception, decision-making, and emotional connection. A brand's visual identity, including its logo, color palette, and typography, has a strong influence on consumer perception, emotional response, and decision-making (Wheeler, 2017). Research suggests that people form opinions about a brand within seconds of seeing its visuals (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). However, many businesses still rely on personal preferences rather than strategic or psychological thinking when creating their brand identity (Olavarrieta & Friedmann, 2007).

This thesis started with a real project – the author was asked by a friend to create a visual identity for a new self-portrait photo studio in Prague. Since the brand didn't exist yet, it was a great opportunity to apply design theory in practice and test how psychology-based visual identity could influence how people feel about a brand. The studio, which was later named Narcis, became the main case study of this research.

This bachelor thesis was motivated by the observation that while visual identity is often treated as a matter of taste, it can be approached more systematically. The goal of this thesis is to explore whether a psychology-based visual identity leads to better brand perception and engagement than a non-psychology based one.

To achieve this goal, two visual identities were developed for the same self-portrait photo studio. One designed using psychological principles, and the other without these considerations. Their effectiveness was tested through a questionnaire distributed among the target audience, and A/B testing using Instagram Story ads. The research was guided by five key questions related to brand recall, logo memorability, emotional impact and social media engagement.

The results from both methods consistently favored the psychology-based visual identity. It achieved higher engagement on Instagram and was rated as more modern, trustworthy, and emotionally resonant by participants of the questionnaire. These findings confirm that applying psychology to visual identity can significantly strengthen how a brand is perceived and interacted with.

Thesis objective

The goal of this thesis is to quantitatively assess the impact of a psychology-based visual identity on brand perception, emotional engagement, and user interaction, compared to a non-strategic identity. This evaluation is based on a 15-day A/B testing campaign on Instagram, using an equal budget of 1,725 CZK per identity, and a structured questionnaire with 93 respondents aged 18–34.

Based on the findings, the thesis also proposes a practical framework that helps companies apply psychological principles – such as color psychology, typography tone, and Gestalt principles in logo design – when creating, changing or updating their visual identity.

The thesis will address the following research questions:

RQ1: Does a psychology-driven visual identity lead to stronger brand recall than a non-strategic identity?

RQ2: How do Gestalt design principles influence the memorability of a logo compared to a logo created without these principles?

RQ3: How do color and typography choices based on psychological principles influence emotional response and brand trust?

RQ4: Does a psychology-based design generate higher engagement in Instagram Story advertisements (profile visits, link clicks, and follows) than a non-psychology-based design?

RQ5: How does a psychology-based visual identity influence emotional connection compared to a non-strategic design?

Methodology overview

To answer the research questions, both A/B testing and a questionnaire will be conducted:

A/B testing was selected for its ability to provide a precise comparison between two distinct visual identities of the same brand under controlled conditions. Two Instagram accounts will be set up, each showcasing one of the visual identities. Both profiles will have identical content strategies, tones of voice, and posting schedules. This approach ensures that any differences in engagement metrics, such as profile visits, external link clicks, cost per profile visit, and the number of followers gained, are most likely linked to the visual identity and not to other variables. To gather sufficient data, two paid social media advertisements will be run for both accounts, targeting the same demographic group - young adults aged 18-35 who value creativity, self-expression, and unique experiences. This group includes young professionals and students, couples and friend groups, influencers and content creators, people celebrating special occasions, and young tourists visiting Prague, as identified based on insights from Matěj Lanča, the owner of Narcis Studio.

Additionally, a questionnaire will be conducted to identify preferences and brand recall for both visual identities within this defined target audience. The questionnaire will collect detailed feedback on specific elements of the visual identity such as color, typography, logo, and overall design appeal. This method ensures that the conclusions are supported not only by observed behaviors but also by direct feedback from respondents.

Instagram was chosen because it is the platform where the studio plans to promote itself and reach its target audience. Since Instagram is highly visual platform and widely used by young people, it was the most relevant place to test how different designs perform. Testing in a real-world setting (like printed posters or store displays) wasn't possible due to limited time and budget, and it wouldn't reflect the digital behavior the studio depends on. The 15-day campaign was long enough to gather useful engagement data while staying within the budget of 1,725 CZK per ad. A longer campaign could have brought more results, but a longer time frame was not realistic due to the limited budget and the thesis schedule.

The questionnaire was chosen to collect opinions and emotional reactions from the target audience. It was easier and faster to use an online form than to do in-person interviews, and it helped gather insights from a larger number of people. This mix of methods made it possible to get both real behavior data and feedback on how people felt about each visual identity.

Although this study focused on Instagram-based testing, alternative methods such as in-person experiments, or longer campaign durations could provide additional insights. Testing physical materials may have revealed different types of emotional engagement, particularly for people who are less active online. Future research could therefore complement digital findings with real-world user testing to strengthen the results.

Theoretical Part

The theoretical part of this thesis explores the fundamental aspects of branding, with a focus on visual identity and its psychological impact on consumer perception. The key elements of visual identity – logo, colors, and typography – are analyzed in relation to their psychological influence on brand recognition, shaping consumer perceptions and building emotional connections.

A significant component of this thesis includes social media branding, with a particular focus on Instagram, a visual-first platform widely used by brands to showcase their visual identities and engage with their target audience. Additionally, the role of A/B testing in design evaluation is examined, illustrating how brands can use this method to refine their visual strategies.

By providing a structured theoretical foundation, this section establishes the key concepts that will be applied in the practical part of the thesis. The findings from this section will help the creation of the two distinct visual identities that will later be tested for effectiveness.

1 Introduction to branding

The way a brand presents itself, whether it's a product, a service, or a non-profit organization determines its success (Wheeler, 2017). Wheeler (2017) claims that people fall in love with brands and associate themselves with them. However, consumers often form an opinion about a product before they try it and certainly before they seek more information about it (Neumeier, 2006). This happens thanks to a well-executed branding process. Branding is a broad subject and encompasses many aspects.

1.1 What is a brand?

The first thing associated with branding is the brand. When people think of a brand, the initial things that come to mind are its logo, name, or the product itself. However, a brand is not something tangible (Millman, 2011). According to Marty Neumeier (2006), *“a brand is a person's gut feeling about a product,”* and when enough individuals share the same gut feeling, a company can be considered to have a brand.

Scott M. Davis (2002) notes that we encounter about 25,000 new products each year and are exposed to approximately 6,000 advertisements daily. How do we determine the right product for us or which service to use? Brands help us identify and make these choices (Wheeler, 2017).

Having a strong well-built brand provides many competitive advantages, including greater customer loyalty, lower price sensitivity, positive word of mouth, and higher rates of intention to purchase (Vit & Gomez-Palacio, 2009).

Consequently, a brand represents how people feel about a product, the emotions they experience when interacting with it, and the information that helps them understand why they should choose that particular product. As Nicolas Ind stated, *“the more we think we know about a product, the less anxiety we feel about our choice”*.

1.2 What is branding?

As mentioned earlier, a brand is linked to our perception, while branding refers to the specific actions a company takes to create and maintain a successful brand.

Branding is the result of the collaborative efforts of designers, researchers, strategists, and writers, where every discipline – from advertising and public relations to design – comes together to effectively communicate the benefits and values of a product or service (Vit & Gomez-Palacio, 2009).

The main goal of branding is to build awareness and increase customer loyalty. The reasons for leveraging branding include the desire to outperform the competition, reach customers, and lead the market (Wheeler, 2017).

According to Wheeler (2017), there are five steps of branding:

- 1. Conducting research**
- 2. Clarifying strategy**
- 3. Designing visual identity**
- 4. Creating touchpoints**
- 5. Managing assets**

Conducting research is the first step a company should take. It involves understanding the company's vision, goals, and values (Wheeler, 2017).

Next, the company defines its positioning, differentiation, competitive advantage, and unique value proposition. This step serves as a roadmap to guide marketing efforts. (Wheeler, 2017).

At the designing an identity stage, designers create a visual identity that effectively communicates using signs and symbols (Wheeler, 2017). Visual identity consists of a logo, colors, typography and second visual elements in a cohesive style (Vit & Gomez-Palacio, 2009).

During creation of touchpoints the priority is to finalize the elements of the visual identity and consider trademark protection (Wheeler, 2017).

Finally, brand guidelines are developed, and the focus shifts to managing the created assets effectively (Wheeler, 2017).

This bachelor's thesis will be focused on the third step of branding: designing a brand identity. It will examine the relationship between visual identity and psychological aspects, analyzing the key factors that contribute to the creation of a successful and impactful visual identity.

1.3 Why is visual identity important?

Unfortunately, most marketing managers lack design knowledge and are often not closely involved in the design process, they often do not fully understand how visual identities affect consumer behavior (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). But the visual design of products, logos and packages is a crucial aspect of brand building (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016).

And there are several reasons for it:

Firstly, we perceive most of the information with our eyes, and daily we are confronted with an overwhelming amount of information, advertisements, and news. Our brain needs help to quickly identify what we want (Davis, 2002). In today's fast-paced world, we need to make decisions extremely quickly, and the first thing we proceed with are the visuals.

Secondly, having a strong visual identity creates higher brand equity (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). Moreover, visually appealing products are perceived of higher quality and have a higher probability of being chosen (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). The role of visual elements such as packaging, typography, colors and logos in building brand equity is well-documented. Logos, for example, facilitate the communication of brand attributes (Park et al., 2013) and significantly influence brand recognition and evaluation (Henderson & Cote, 1998). Additionally, they support customers in expressing their values and impact purchase decisions (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). Packaging also plays a critical role, drawing customer attention, shaping product categorization, and influencing consumer perceptions (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). Together, these elements strengthen the brand-consumer relationship (Underwood, 2003).

Thirdly, a strong visual identity helps define and communicate the structure and relationships within a brand's architecture (Schultz, Csaba, & Antorini, 2005). A great example is FedEx, originally founded as Federal Express in 1971. The company underwent a significant rebranding in 1994, adopting the nickname "FedEx" and designing a logo with a hidden arrow between the "E" and "X," symbolizing precision and forward movement (Evolution of the Logos, n.d.).

FedEx further differentiated its business units by assigning distinct color codes to the "Ex" portion of the logo, as shown in Figure 1, – purple for Express, green for Ground, red for Freight, blue for Office, and yellow for Trade Networks. This approach ensures clarity and consistency, allowing customers to easily distinguish between services while reinforcing the overall brand identity (Schultz, Csaba, & Antorini, 2005).

Figure 1 FedEx logo



(Evolution of the Logos, n.d.)

Fourthly, the creation of a fitting visual identity is an investment that continuously pays off by increasing brand value over time. The more times people encounter a well-designed visual identity, the faster they recognize and remember the associated product or service (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). This familiarity builds trust and ensures the brand remains top of mind when consumers make purchasing decisions (Wheeler, 2017).

Furthermore, visual identity elements are important in communicating the perceived quality of a product or service. If the visual design aligns with the quality of the offering, it enhances credibility and reinforces consumer expectations (Batra, Seifert, & Brei, 2016). Conversely, a disconnect between product quality and its visual identity risks damaging the brand-consumer relationship, as consumers are unlikely to continue supporting a brand that fails to deliver on its visual promise (Wheeler, 2017). This reinforces the importance of aligning visual design with brand values to create lasting impressions and drive customer loyalty.

1.4 Influence of visual identity on consumer perception

The critical role of visual identity in consumer decision-making is well recognized. Visual identity is not just a good-looking design. It encompasses the entire spectrum of sensory interactions that a consumer has with a brand (Preprints.org, 2024).

A well-designed visual identity can significantly influence consumer perceptions and behaviors, as evidenced by systematic research (Preprints.org, 2024). For instance, the study found that specific elements of visual identity such as logos and color schemes play pivotal roles in shaping consumer trust and brand loyalty. It highlighted that consumers are 30% more likely to trust brands with a clear, consistent visual identity compared to those without (Preprints.org, 2024).

Expanding on these findings, research published in the International Journal of Novel Research and Development (2024) demonstrates that main visual identity elements like color can impact consumer perceptions of brand attributes such as reliability and professionalism. The study cited an experiment where brands with a blue-themed visual identity were perceived as significantly more reliable and professional by 20% of the participants compared to those with a warmer color palette (IJNRD, 2024).

These insights prove the importance of strategic and psychology-based visual branding. Brands should carefully design their visual identities to resonate with target audiences, facilitating not just recognition but also emotional connection.

2 Effective visual brand identity

“Most people think that corporate identity is about symbols, logotypes, colors, typography, even about buildings, products, furniture, about visual appearance, design. And it is.” (Olins, 1989)

Symbolism is often the first thing that comes to mind when people think about a brand's visual identity. Iconic elements such as the Nike swoosh, McDonald's golden arches, or Apple's bitten apple are more than just recognizable symbols – they embody the essence of their well-known brands. As Brian Collins explains, *“brands exist in the minds of people who interact with them,”* and these interactions are shaped by both the quality of the product or service and the thoughtfully designed visual elements that support them (Millman, 2011). Visual identity is not limited to a logo; it encompasses a wide set of components, including websites, business cards, staff uniforms, packaging, and even tone of voice. These elements collectively create a cohesive and memorable brand experience.

When considering what a customer might see, hear, or feel when interacting with a brand through packaging, social media, or photography – each detail contributes to the overall identity. Effective visual branding does not need to be overly complex; instead, it should include only what is necessary to convey the brand's message clearly and consistently (Millman, 2011).

For a visual identity to be effective, it must align with the values, demographics, and psychological profiles of its target audience (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). Essential components of a visual identity can convey different meanings to different groups. Therefore, understanding the audience's needs and desires is crucial for evaluating design elements. Testing whether a design effectively resonates with the intended audience ensures the success of the visual identity (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010).

This thesis will be focused on the primary elements of visual identity – logos, colors, and typography, analyzing how these components contribute to creating a successful and impactful brand identity. It also delves into the psychological aspects of these elements, including the role of logo design in enhancing memorability and effectiveness, the application of Gestalt principles, the psychological influence of color schemes on consumer behavior, and the impact of typography on brand perception. By examining these factors, the thesis aims to demonstrate how intentional and thoughtful visual design fosters stronger emotional connections with potential consumers and enhances overall brand success.

2.1 Target audience

Brand owners have the authority to approve and finance design projects, which often leads designers to tailor their work to meet the preferences of their clients. However, it is ultimately the customers who generate revenue for the company. So, it is impossible for designers to create a functional visual identity if a designer will not focus on the end-user (Dang, 2018).

It is crucial to understand the needs, desires, and aspirations of a potential customer (Christenson, n.d.).

To identify this, it is important to analyze the following key factors:

1. **Demographics.** Characteristics such as age, income, location, and education level.
2. **Psychographics.** Values, interests, lifestyle choices, and personality traits.
3. **Pain Points.** Challenges or problems an audience faces and how a brand can address them.

Through comprehensive market research and the development of detailed buyer personas, one can gain critical insights that will inform and shape the creation of a brand identity (Christenson, n.d.).

In addition to demographics, understanding the psychology and needs of the target audience is vital for building a successful visual identity (Dang, 2018). Designers must carefully consider how the target group perceives and reacts to specific colors, shapes, and imagery when selecting and creating visual elements (Christenson, n.d.).

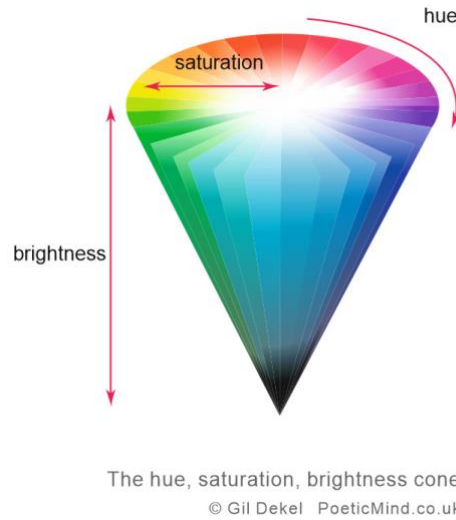
Consequently, before starting to work on creating a successful visual identity comprehensive market research and a deep understanding of the target audience are needed. This ensures that both the brand's values and the audience's needs are reflected in the visual identity (Christenson, n.d.).

2.2 Color

In a fast-paced visual world, where first impressions are made in a fraction of a second, color plays a vital role in capturing attention and conveying information (Chang & Lin, 2010). It helps viewers form immediate associations or reactions to a brand or product. Additionally, color functions as a tool for achieving compositional balance and communicating meaning effectively (Sherin, 2012).

When selecting colors for a brand, it's important to consider the fundamental aspects of color, as shown in Figure 2: hue (e.g., red vs. blue), saturation (e.g., bright blue vs. muted blue gray), and brightness (e.g., light blue vs. dark blue) (Budelmann, Kim & Wozniak, 2010).

Figure 2 Hue, Saturation, Brightness



(Dr. Gil Dekel, 2016)

Hue refers to the term commonly used for color. It represents the dominant wavelength of light that the human eye perceives, such as red, blue, or green (Sherin, 2012).

Saturation describes the intensity or purity of a color. It reflects how vivid and vibrant the color appears, which is determined by the amount of grey mixed with it. A color without any grey, such as pure red, is highly saturated, appearing bright and vivid (Sherin, 2012).

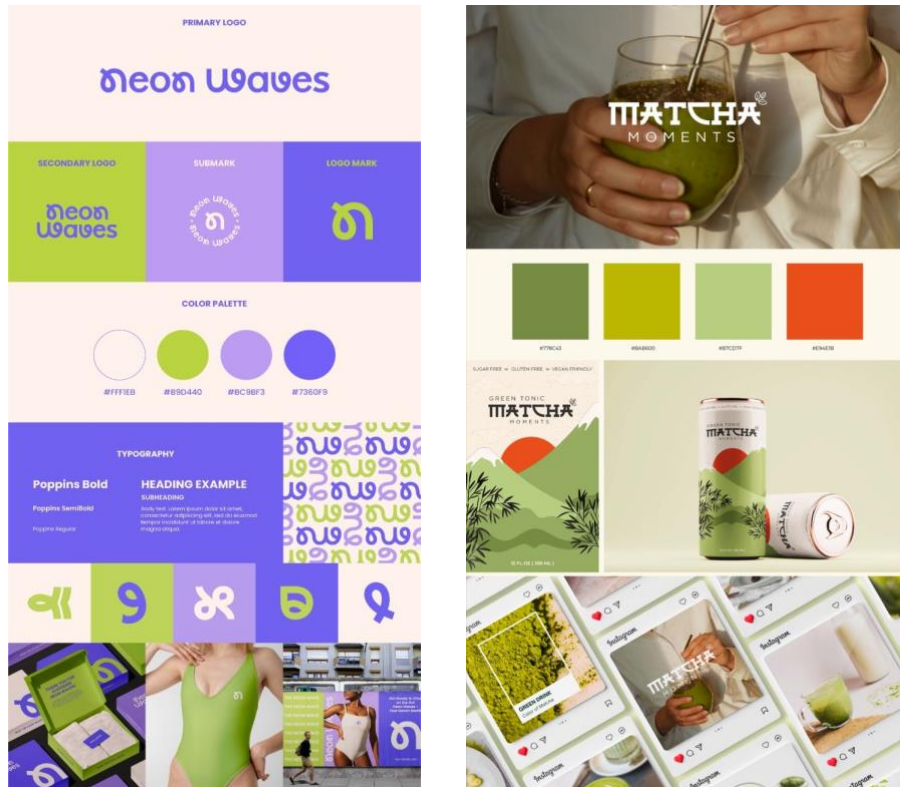
Brightness refers to the degree of lightness or darkness in a color, influenced by the presence of black or white. For example, when a significant amount of black is mixed with red, the red appears darker and less bright. Conversely, when white dominates, the red becomes fully bright and luminous (Sherin, 2012).

Each of these elements contributes to the overall impression and intended emotional response. By understanding and leveraging the psychological and visual effects of color, designers can craft identities that resonate deeply with their target audience.

2.2.1 Color and brand recognition

Brand recognition refers to a consumer's ability to identify and associate a product with a specific brand. Designers establish this recognition through a consistent combination of colors and shapes while creating a visual identity. It is important to be consistent and maintain the same colors across all aspects of a company such as its social media, print products, website, storefront, and other assets, as it enhances visual relatability, as demonstrated on Figure 3 (Kumar, 2017).

Figure 3 Consistent visual identities



(Pinterest, n.d.)

A study conducted by researchers at the University of Loyola found that color can increase brand recognition by up to 80% (Morton, n.d.). Additionally, in an experiment where participants viewed three-second advertisements, over 62% associated brands with the colors they saw, highlighting the strong role color plays in brand recall (Chang & Lin, 2010).

Brand recognition significantly influences consumer purchasing behavior (Kumar, 2017). While impulse shoppers may make quick decisions, many consumers actively seek out brands they recognize (Kumar, 2017). By strategically using color, brands make it easier for consumers to locate their products among similar options. Once a brand achieves strong recognition, it can experiment with color variations to generate interest (Kumar, 2017).

A good example is Heinz (see Figure 4), which is widely associated with its signature red ketchup bottles.

Figure 4 Heinz regular red ketchup bottles



(Smithsonian Magazine, n.d.)

In October 2000, the company introduced EZ Squirt Blastin' Green ketchup, a dramatic shift from its traditional red packaging, as shown in Figure 5.

Figure 5 EZ Squirt Blastin' Green ketchup bottle



(The Nibble, 2016)

More than 25 million bottles of unusual colored ketchup were sold, which helped Heinz capture an all-time high of 60% of the United States ketchup market (Zax, 2011). This unconventional change led to a \$23 million increase in sales, demonstrating how color can effectively capture consumer attention and drive purchases (Zax, 2011).

2.2.2 Color and brand identity

The strong connection between color and brand identity is inevitable. Labrecque and Milne (2012), writing in the Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science, state that *“like a carefully chosen brand name, color carries intrinsic meaning that becomes central to the brand’s identity, contributes to brand recognition, and communicates the desired image.”*

Beyond recognition, color also plays a role in conveying brand personality and identity. It acts as a non-verbal communication tool, influencing customer perceptions (Kumar, 2017).

Studies suggest that within 90 seconds of encountering a product, consumers form an initial judgment, with 62%-90% of their perception being influenced by color alone (Chang & Lin, 2010). Logos in particular serve as visual representations of a whole brand, and even without prior exposure, people begin to associate certain qualities with a brand based only on its primary logo color (Kumar, 2017).

Color mapping is a useful technique for determining suitable logo colors for new brands while ensuring differentiation in a crowded market. A study on logo color examined how consumers perceived the appropriateness of different colors for various fictional brands. Participants evaluated products presented in eight different colors and assessed how well each color aligned with the product’s purpose (Kumar, 2017).

The results indicated a clear pattern: functional products, those that serve a practical need or solve a problem were best suited to “functional” colors, whereas sensory-social products, those that influence status, attitudes, or social identity were better represented by “sensory-social” colors (Kumar, 2017).

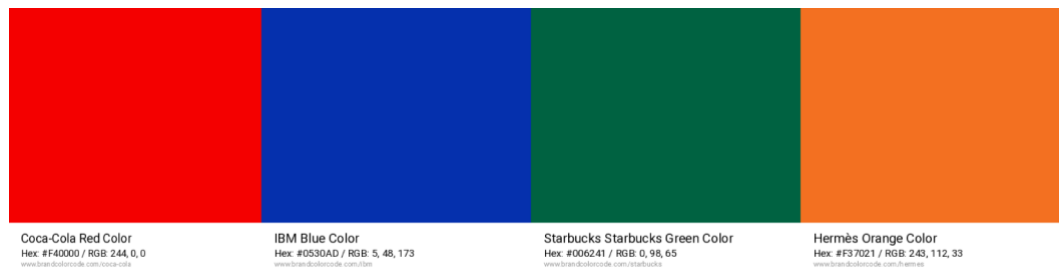
Functional colors are typically associated with reliability. These colors are often perceived as stable, trustworthy and professional. For example, blue, green, black and grey. While sensory-social colors are often linked to emotions, feelings and social interactions. They are usually chosen to create emotional connections with customers and associate a brand with specific feelings. Examples of sensory-social colors are red, yellow, orange and purple (Kumar, 2017).

2.2.3 Color psychology and target audience

Color impact varies depending on how it is used and the audience it targets (Kumar, 2017). Color perception is different across individuals, meaning experimental findings cannot be universally applied.

A study published in the African Journal of Business Management by Chang and Lin (2010) examined consumer reactions to brand colors used by well-known companies, including Coca-Cola, IBM, Starbucks and Hermes (see Figure 6).

Figure 6 Coca-Cola, IBM, Starbucks, Hermes – brand colors



(Brand Color Code, n.d.)

The research found that Coca-Cola's red was associated with excitement, youthfulness, and energy, while Hermès' orange conveyed boldness, uniqueness, and confidence. Starbucks' green signified relaxation, leisure, and comfort, whereas IBM's blue evoked professionalism, trust, and reliability (Chang, Lun, & Lin, 2010).

Consumer responses to color are influenced by various factors, including personality, age, gender, and cultural background (Kumar, 2017). While certain color associations remain widely accepted, their impact on consumer behavior can differ based on individual traits.

For instance, specific color shades appeal to different shopper personalities. Fast-food chains and clearance sales frequently use high-stimulation colors like red, orange, and black to create urgency and encourage impulse purchases (Kumar, 2017).

For example, fast-food chains such as McDonald's and Burger King use red and yellow to evoke urgency, energy, and speed, signaling efficiency to customers, as shown in Figure 7 (Kumar, 2017).

Figure 7 McDonald's and Burger King's color palettes



(Color Hex, n.d.)

Meanwhile, Whole Foods incorporates green into its branding to emphasize its commitment to sustainability and health-conscious values, as Figure 8 represents (Kumar, 2017).

Figure 8 Whole Foods green color



Whole Foods Kale Green Color
Hex: #006F46 / RGB: 0, 111, 70
www.brandcolorcode.com/whole-foods

(Brand Color Code, n.d.)

In contrast, retail clothing stores often incorporate softer hues like pink and sky blue to establish a calming atmosphere for traditional shoppers who prefer to browse at a relaxed pace (Kumar, 2017).

Color preferences also vary across demographic groups. Research suggests that 76% of women prefer cool colors, compared to 56% of men (Hemphill, 1996). Additionally, men are more inclined to favor colors such as blue, black, brown, green, and red, whereas women tend to prefer blue, orange, yellow, purple, green, and red (Hemphill, 1996).

Studies indicate that women tend to be more emotional and deliberate shoppers, whereas men are often more decisive and efficient. However, both men and women experience increased heart rates when confronted with a significant sale, reinforcing the emotional impact of color (Kumar, 2017).

Age plays a role as well, with younger children, particularly seven-year-olds, displaying a stronger preference for yellow than adults (Boyatzis & Varghese, 1994). Moreover, men tend to gravitate toward orange over yellow, while women exhibit the opposite preference (Boyatzis & Varghese, 1994).

Cultural background further shapes the interpretation of colors. For example, while purple signifies royalty in Europe, it is linked to excessive spending in China (Kumar, 2017). Similarly, white is associated with purity in Western and Middle Eastern cultures, but it represents mourning in Japan and China (Kumar, 2017). In the United States and Europe, blue is commonly linked to trust and authority, making it a popular choice for business advertisements. However, in Japan, blue can symbolize immorality or betrayal, attributes that businesses would typically avoid conveying (Kumar, 2017).

2.2.4 Associations with colors

Colors evoke psychological responses that influence consumer behavior. The meanings assigned to different hues differ from both cultural and psychological factors. According to Elliot and Maier (2007), colors affect cognitive processing and decision-making tendencies.

For instance, red is associated with urgency and excitement, which explains its frequent use in sales promotions and fast-food branding (Birren, 1997). Conversely, blue conveys trust and stability, making it a popular choice among banks and technology firms (Huang, Lin, & Chiang, 2008).

Furthermore, the psychological impact of color extends beyond simple associations. Studies indicate that high-saturation colors evoke stronger emotional reactions, while desaturated or pastel tones create a more subdued effect (Valdez & Mehrabian, 1994). The brightness of a color also influences perception – too fluorescent hues can be overwhelming, whereas muted tones appear sophisticated and calming (Elliot & Maier, 2007).

Some brands leverage this effectively, for example McDonald's. In bustling food courts or roadside settings, the bright yellow of the golden arches stands out, serving as an unmistakable sign, demonstrated in Figure 9.

Figure 9 McDonald's road sign



(Nice Content Studio, n.d.)

Naz and Epps (2004) conducted a study published in the *College Students Journal*, analyzing how college students described various colors.

Their findings indicate that green is most commonly linked to nature and evokes positive emotions such as relaxation and calmness. Blue, associated with water, connects with the feelings of comfort and peace. Red is strongly connected to love and is perceived as a dominant color. Black is often associated with power, while yellow and orange are linked to happiness.

Similarly, Clarke and Cotsall (2008) examined the common words participants used to describe colors. Their study found that 75% of respondents associated red with words like “anger,” “energy,” and “passion.” Yellow and orange received more cheerful descriptions, whereas green and blue were frequently described as “peaceful,” “relaxing,” “clean,” and

“calming.” Additionally, 69% of participants associated black with concepts like evil or death, while over 88% linked white with terms such as “innocence,” “happy,” and “euphoria.” Pink was connected to femininity by 70% of respondents. However, there was less consensus regarding the meanings of brown, grey, and purple. The study also revealed that brighter hues tend to be perceived more positively.

By understanding these associations, businesses can develop more impactful branding strategies that emotionally resonate with their target audience (JDSD, 2021).

Figure 10 shows a connection between colors and emotions that they usually evoke.

Figure 10 Colors and emotions



(London Image Institute, n.d.)

However, these responses are not universal. One person might find red exciting and appealing, while another might associate it with blood and danger (Kumar, 2017). Context and audience play a crucial role. Black, for instance, can convey stability and dependability in one situation, while appearing edgy and rugged in another; or green may signify "go," symbolize environmental sustainability, or represent the Brazilian national football team, depending on the context (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). Cultural background, gender, and age further influence how colors are perceived, highlighting the complexity of color psychology (Sherin, 2012).

While much of the existing literature highlights specific associations between colors and emotions, it is important to note that some researchers argue that color-emotion connections are not universal and may differ based on many cultural and individual factors (Elliot & Maier, 2007). Additionally, color preferences can be influenced by personal experiences and context (Sherin, 2012). This thesis mainly builds on the established psychological principles but acknowledges that color psychology remains a complex and sometimes debated field.

2.3. Logo

The term logo is an abbreviation of logotype, which refers to the graphic representation of a brand. Essentially, a logo is an image that encapsulates the collective experiences and perceptions people associate with an organization (Budermann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010).

A well-crafted logo provides numerous advantages for brands. It can capture consumer interest, set a brand apart from competitors, enhance brand recognition, influence investor decisions, and communicate the essence of the brand. As a highly visible communication tool, a logo appears across various touchpoints, including products, websites, annual reports, and business cards. This makes it one of the most frequently encountered brand elements, especially by consumers (Wheeler, 2017).

A successful logo is more than just a visual mark – it's a tool for creating an emotional connection with the audience. Logos that tell a story or convey a distinct visual concept, such as the Baskin Robbins “31 flavors” logo (see Figure 11) or the Twitter bird (see Figure 12), capture attention and evoke emotional responses (Budermann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010).

Figure 11 Baskin Robbins logo



(Baskin-Robbins, n.d.)

Figure 12 Twitter logo



(DWG Logo, n.d.)

These logos (Figures 11 and 12) are memorable, conceptual, and bold, making them irresistible to their audiences. As Paul Howalt and Von Glitschka (2013) emphasize, a logo must promise not only quality and consistency but also a specific emotional experience and a sense of belonging to a community. By doing so, logos become powerful psychological tools, fostering recognition, trust, and loyalty while embedding the brand in the consumer's mind and heart.

When consumers purchase products prominently displaying a brand's logo, such as a bag from a shoe company, get a tattoo of a tech company's logo, or even write songs about a car company, it becomes clear that these logos symbolize more than just the products they represent (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). A logo can evoke a deeper connection when it resonates with values like health, education, or community, transforming the brand into more than a simple business proposition (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). Logos that foster a sense of belonging and emotional connection with their audience tend to build lasting value over time. This highlights the importance of designing logos that are not only visually striking but also meaningful.

2.3.1. How to create a good logo based on psychology

Understanding the psychological principles behind logo design is essential for creating a brand identity that resonates with the brand's potential customers. Effective logo design is something more than just personal preferences for colors or symbols; it involves a meticulous process of research, awareness, and precision. Recognizing the meanings associated with specific shapes and color combinations enables designers to design logos with intentionality and purpose (Wheeler, 2017).

The Gestalt theory according to the designer and educator Mia Cinelli holds significant value for designers and plays a crucial role in the psychology of logo design. Developed by German psychologists Kurt Koffka, Max Wertheimer, and Wolfgang Köhler, this theory says that the whole is greater than the sum of its parts, aiming to explain how humans perceive visual information (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.). Gestalt psychologists propose that people do not perceive their surroundings as isolated components but rather as unified wholes (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.).

The Gestalt principles explain the mind's tendency to simplify complex images, allowing individuals to interpret them in a structured way. This instinctive tendency to process visual information influences how the elements within an image form meaningful visual relationship with one another (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.).

The key Gestalt design principles are:

1. **Proximity.** The arrangement of elements within a logo and their spatial closeness, which suggests relationships or groupings.
2. **Similarity.** The visual connection between elements with shared attributes, such as shapes or colors, creating a sense of unity or association.
3. **Closure.** The use of negative space to imply a complete image, even when certain parts are missing, allowing viewers to perceive the whole.
4. **Continuity.** The alignment of elements to guide the eye and create a sense of flow, which can draw attention to specific parts of the logo.
5. **Figure-ground.** The interplay between a logo's foreground and background, enabling viewers to see them as a cohesive whole.
6. **Symmetry.** Although not all logos need to be symmetrical, this principle emphasizes proportion and balance to enhance the design's visual harmony.

Thanks to these principles, logo designs can appear more cohesive and visually engaging. For instance, logos such as the World Wildlife Fund (WWF), Unilever, and the Olympic rings, demonstrated in Figure 13, illustrate the effective use of Gestalt principles, resulting in designs that are both memorable and impactful.

Figure 13 Logos based on Gestalt Principles



(Wix Blog, n.d.)

Integrating these psychological insights into the logo design process can help brands develop visual identities that not only capture attention but also foster meaningful connections with their target audiences.

2.4 Typography. How font choices influence perception

Typography has personality (Budelmann, Kim, & Wozniak, 2010). Choosing the right typeface means selecting one that conveys the appropriate tone for the brand, starting with the fundamental choice between serif and sans serif fonts.

Serif typefaces, that are shown in Figure 14, with their varying line thicknesses, trace their origins to the pressure points of a calligrapher's hand, which is why they are often associated with tradition.

Figure 14 Fonts with serifs



(Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.)

On the other hand, sans serif typefaces, being more recent, are typically linked to modernity (see Figure 15). For example, Helvetica is a sans serif font since it doesn't have any serifs.

Figure 15 Fonts without serifs



(Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.)

Inna Saltz (2009) writes that typography significantly amplifies the emotional tone of a message. For example, a delicate italic font might beautifully convey the lyrical nature of a poem about the environment, while a bold, heavy serif could deliver the gravity of a political declaration (Saltz, 2009). Similarly, the scholarly feel of an old-style serif font may add credibility to a well-argued debate (Saltz, 2009). Choosing the right typeface is critical to enhancing the message's intent, as the wrong choice can undermine its authenticity and impact.

Other design elements also contribute to emotional resonance. Rounded shapes and lighter-weight fonts often convey a more feminine quality, commonly used in cosmetic packaging. In contrast, fonts designed for male-oriented products tend to be heavier, with sharp, squared-off characteristics that give them a more "muscular" appearance (Saltz, 2009).

Inna Saltz (2009) states that color too plays a role in the emotional perception of typography. Warmer or subdued tones are often seen as feminine, while bold primary colors appeal to younger audiences. On the other hand, darker shades like burgundy, forest green, and navy blue are considered more masculine. While these associations are rooted in stereotypes, they are effective tools for targeting specific audiences and evoking the desired emotional response (Saltz, 2009).

Typography is essential for structuring information, directing attention to specific elements, and establishing a seamless visual flow that enables the audience to quickly understand and process the key messages of a brand's communication (Wei & Yin, 2024).

2.5 Visual identity and psychology

Graphic design plays a crucial role in helping companies establish a distinctive brand image and shape consumer perceptions. Elements such as logos, colors, typography, and visual identity as a whole significantly influence how consumers perceive and interact with a brand. By leveraging these visual components, businesses can capture attention, influence purchasing behavior, enhance brand experiences, and evoke emotional responses from their target audience (Wei & Yin, 2024). The psychological impact of design is evident in elements like symmetrical logos, which convey harmony or the visual connection between elements with shared attributes, such as shapes or colors, creating a sense of unity or association; specific colors, which evoke emotional reactions; and different fonts, each of them influencing an emotional perception of a brand in its own way (Wei & Yin, 2024).

Visual branding is a powerful tool for communicating a brand's personality, values, and market positioning. To remain competitive, companies should adopt modern graphic design strategies, maintain consistency in visual identity across all channels and touchpoints, and update their brand's visual identity to stay relevant (Wei & Yin, 2024). In today's saturated and highly competitive markets, strong graphic design is essential for businesses to create a lasting impression and captivate their audience (Wei & Yin, 2024).

3 Social media as a tool for showcasing visual identities

Social media has become an essential tool for brands to establish and communicate their visual identity with their potential customers. The shift from traditional marketing channels to digital platforms has reshaped branding strategies, with organizations leveraging social media to maintain a strong presence and engage with their audience (Krake, 2014). Unlike traditional advertising, which often relies on one-way communication, social media fosters interaction between brands and consumers, allowing for immediate feedback (Kaplan & Haenlein, 2010).

Social media platforms have become powerful marketing tools, where graphic design plays a pivotal role in capturing consumer attention and encouraging engagement (Wei & Yin, 2024). Visually striking brand posts on social media generate higher interaction, fostering stronger brand associations (Hamzah, Wahab, & Waqas, 2021). The rise of technology and social media has increased visibility and enhanced consumer interaction, where customer engagement is the main goal.

Research indicates that brands maintaining a consistent visual identity across different platforms enhance their brand recognition and credibility (Van den Bosch, de Jong, & Elving, 2004).

However, studies show that many organizations struggle with maintaining visual consistency across various platforms, often adapting their brand aesthetics to suit platform-specific features rather than maintaining a unified look (Krake, 2014).

Another critical aspect of branding on social media is its role in shaping consumer perception. As users scroll through their feeds, they encounter countless visuals, and brands must ensure their content stands out (Krake, 2014).

Studies suggest that visual identity plays a crucial role in consumers' ability to recognize and recall a brand. A well-executed visual identity strengthens brand equity, increases engagement, and fosters brand loyalty (Hinz et al., 2011). When visually engaging branding content captures the audience's attention, it leads to deeper and more meaningful

interactions (Wei & Yin, 2024). Furthermore, organizations that effectively implement their visual identity on social media tend to see higher engagement rates and increased consumer trust (Krake, 2014).

3.1 Instagram as a visual-first platform

Instagram stands out as a highly visual platform, making it an essential tool for businesses aiming to build their brand presence. Unlike many other social media networks, Instagram is unlikely to lose relevance in the foreseeable future (Iseli, 2021). Its steadily growing user base is supported by the platform's continuous introduction of innovative features such as Instagram Stories, Instagram Posts, and Instagram Reels, which help it remain versatile and competitive.

Iseli (2021) states that one of Instagram's primary strengths lies in its ability to connect businesses with consumers in a visually engaging manner. Many users rely on Instagram as a shopping tool to discover products and services, making it an effective platform for businesses to showcase offerings. Furthermore, a significant portion of Instagram users follow business accounts, broadening opportunities for brand engagement beyond personal connections (Iseli, 2021).

Instagram's demographic predominantly consists of users under the age of 35, making it particularly suitable for brands targeting younger audiences (Iseli, 2021). However, due to the platform's widespread popularity, it also attracts older generations. Industries such as fashion, hospitality, retail, education, sports, and entertainment benefit greatly from Instagram's emphasis on visual communication, allowing businesses to present their products and services creatively and effectively (Instagram Business, n.d.).

Instagram provides businesses with a unique opportunity to foster brand recognition, connect with a diverse audience, and maintain relevance in a competitive digital landscape (Iseli, 2021).

Moreover, Instagram offers advanced targeting tools, enabling marketers to reach their audience based on demographics, interests, and behaviors (Instagram Business, n.d.). This level of precision allows for the creation of campaigns that resonate with specific target demographics, potentially increasing engagement and conversion rates (Sharma & Ashfaq, 2023). That's why this platform will be used for A/B testing two distinct visual identities for the self-portrait studio.

3.2 A/B testing importance in design

A/B testing in design, also referred to as split testing, is a quantitative research method that compares two versions of a design to determine which performs better. In this process, "A" typically represents one design, while "B" another. This method is widely used across marketing, social media, and retail but is particularly effective in design, including website and application development (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.).

There are a lot of benefits of A/B testing. It is cost-effective, allowing businesses to implement tests with live users without requiring expensive pre-launch environments. For instance, a product manager can test two landing page designs by splitting web traffic between them, and thanks to that getting valuable insights without significant additional costs. Furthermore, A/B testing delivers rapid results, often within just a few weeks, making it an efficient tool for collecting actionable data (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.).

In graphic design, A/B testing holds particular importance. It helps designers create visuals that resonate with the target audience by analyzing key metrics such as engagement and conversion rates. For example, comparing two call-to-action buttons or visual layouts can reveal which design generates higher user interactions, ensuring the final design aligns with user preferences (Graphics Zoo, n.d.).

Additionally, A/B testing enables low-risk modifications. Instead of committing to a full redesign, designers can make small changes, such as adjusting colors or typography and assess user responses. This minimizes the risk of negatively affecting conversion rates while allowing designers to refine and optimize their work. By aligning visual elements with user preferences, A/B testing helps create designs that are not only aesthetically appealing but also functional and effective (Graphics Zoo, n.d.).

Ultimately, A/B testing provides designers with valuable insights. By systematically evaluating different variations, this method ensures that each design decision contributes meaningfully to the user experience and overall brand success. In this thesis A/B testing will be utilized to assess the effectiveness of two distinct visual identities. One identity will be carefully designed by incorporating the principles of design psychology, taking into account factors such as the psychology of logos, colors, typography, and alignment with the target audience's unique traits. In contrast, the second identity will be created without applying these psychological principles or considering the audience's characteristics.

4 Summary of the theoretical part

The theoretical part of the thesis emphasizes the importance of visual identity in branding, focusing on the psychological impact of its components – colors, logo, and typography. The psychological aspects of these elements are highlighted, especially how these elements shape consumer perceptions and build emotional connections.

The role of social media, especially Instagram as a highly visual platform, is explored as a tool for showcasing visual identities. A/B testing is presented as a valuable method for testing visual identities to meet audience preferences. These insights build the foundation for the practical part of the thesis, where the discussed principles will be applied and tested on visual identities for the self-portrait studio.

Practical Part

The practical part of this bachelor's thesis focuses on the creation and evaluation of two distinct visual identities for the same self-portrait photo studio "Narcis". The first visual identity will be designed considering psychological principles. The main elements such as logos, colors, and typography will be strategically tailored to the target audience of the studio. Logo will be created with the implementation of Gestalt principles, colors will be chosen based on color psychology to reflect the intended emotions, typography will match the intended emotional tone and brand message. The second identity, by contrast, will be created without applying these psychological considerations, instead relying on arbitrary design choices that do not take psychological perception into account.

To assess their effectiveness, both identities will be tested through A/B testing on Instagram. Two separate profiles, each showcasing one of the visual identities, will be created while ensuring consistency in tone of voice, content type, and posting schedule. Additionally, both identities will be promoted through identical paid advertisements targeted at the same audience, allowing for a direct comparison of engagement rates.

Beyond quantitative insights from A/B testing, a questionnaire will be conducted among the target audience to gather qualitative feedback. This will help determine which visual identity resonates more with the target audience and why.

It is expected that the identity designed with psychological principles will perform better in terms of engagement and audience preference, highlighting the role of psychology in branding.

5 Self-portrait photo studio overview

Narcis Studio is a self-portrait photo studio set to open in Prague in May 2025, offering a unique concept where visitors take on the roles of both a photographer and a model. In a private room with a large mirror, guests can enjoy a creative and personal experience, whether spending time alone or sharing it with loved ones. The name "Narcis" reflects a celebration of self-love, highlighting the importance of dedicating time and care to oneself.

Unlike traditional self-portrait studios with minimalist aesthetics, Narcis Studio is designed to be vibrant and full of energy, appealing to young, creative individuals looking for more than just a space to take pictures. The studio combines bold design, playful decorations, and an inviting atmosphere that encourages visitors to express themselves freely. Guests can also play their own music during sessions, adding a personal touch to the experience.

Narcis Studio also offers a space for celebrations, allowing guests to host parties while creating lasting memories by capturing photos with their loved ones. By offering a modern and inspiring environment, the studio aims to empower individuals to explore their creativity, embrace self-expression, and capture moments that truly reflect who they are.

5.1 Narcis's target audience

According to an interview with Matěj Lanča (personal communication, February 10, 2025), Narcis Studio's primary target audience consists of young adults aged 18-35, living in urban areas, who value creativity, self-expression, and unique experiences. They often prioritize spending their time and money on meaningful activities, such as exploring new hobbies, travelling or creating lasting memories with loved ones, rather than buying material things.

There are several buying personas according to Narcis Studio's positioning (personal communication, February 10, 2025):

1. **Young professionals and students.** Individuals interested in creative activities and visually inspiring spaces, often looking for ways to unwind, express themselves, or celebrate personal milestones in an unusual way.
2. **Couples and friend groups.** People seeking a fun and intimate environment for spending time together, celebrating birthdays, anniversaries, and other special occasions.
3. **Influencers and content creators.** Those who want to produce engaging and high-quality content for their personal or professional platforms. The studio's vibrant and modern aesthetic provides the perfect setting for such photos and videos.
4. **People who want to celebrate special occasions.** Narcis Studio is suitable for organizing small-scale events, such as parties or friends gatherings for people who do not want to gather together at home or at a cafe but seek for vibrant and versatile space for creating memorable experiences in privacy.
5. **Young tourists visiting Prague.** Travelers looking for a distinctive and creative experience during their visit to the city. Photo sessions last from 15 to 90 minutes, so it is a perfect addition to exploring the city and remembering the trip in an unusual way.

5.2 Brief

The work process with a client typically begins with a brief – a structured questionnaire that the client completes during a personal meeting, online call, or in written form. The purpose of this questionnaire is to understand the client's vision, preferences, and expectations to create a functional design that aligns with their vision and goals.

Before developing the visual identity for Narcis Studio, a meeting was held with Matěj Lanča on the 10th of February 2025, the owner of the studio. During this meeting, a lot of questions about the studio were answered, here are some of them (personal communication, February 10, 2025):

1) What is the name of your self-portrait studio? Does it have any specific meaning?

Name: Narcis/Narcis Studio

Since it is a self-portrait studio, our visitors take on the roles of both model and photographer. They are alone in a room with a large mirror, taking their time to enjoy the experience. While it may sound a bit self-centered, our aim is to present narcissism in a positive light as a celebration of self-love.

2) Do you have a tagline or slogan to include?

We currently have several potential options:

“Your story, your way”,

“A space to shine”,

“The art is in you”.

For now, we plan to use just the name "Narcis" or "Narcis Studio" in the logo, and we may incorporate one of the taglines later.

3) What inspired you to start this business?

The concept of a self-portrait studio is highly functional – you don’t need to hire a professional photographer to get high-quality photos, nor do you have to feel shy in front of a stranger giving you directions. Instead, visitors can take on the role of both model and photographer, offering a unique opportunity to see themselves from a new perspective.

We often don’t get enough time to spend with ourselves or our loved ones. A self-portrait studio provides a creative and intimate space to enjoy with friends, share special moments, and explore dual roles as both model and photographer.

While there are other self-portrait studios in Prague, Narcis Studio aims to go beyond the traditional black-and-white aesthetic. Our vision is to create a vibrant and welcoming space tailored to young, energetic individuals seeking more than just a place to take pictures. We want the studio to evoke bright, lively emotions and foster self-expression and creativity.

Additionally, Narcis Studio will be available for celebrations, offering a versatile venue for creating memories. Guests can play their own music during sessions, adding a relaxed and personal touch to the atmosphere.

4) What is your mission statement?

We are a bold and modern self-portrait studio in Prague, where art, fun, and self-confidence come together to let you take control of your own narrative.

5) What sets your studio apart from competitors?

Attention to detail:

Every guest receives thoughtful extras, such as an easy-to-follow instruction guide, a sticker pack to personalize their experience, and a loyalty card. The loyalty card includes a personal code that gives friends a discount on their first photoshoot and rewards the guest with a discount on their next session. These small touches show our commitment to customer satisfaction and encourage loyalty and word-of-mouth promotion.

Stylish decorations:

Our studio features fun and creative decorations designed to make photoshoots more engaging and unique. These elements encourage visitors to experiment and add personality to their portraits.

Conveyor belt:

No other self-portrait studios in Prague offer a conveyor belt, which adds movement and dynamism to photos, making them more vibrant and alive. This feature transforms the traditional self-portrait experience into more creative and engaging shots.

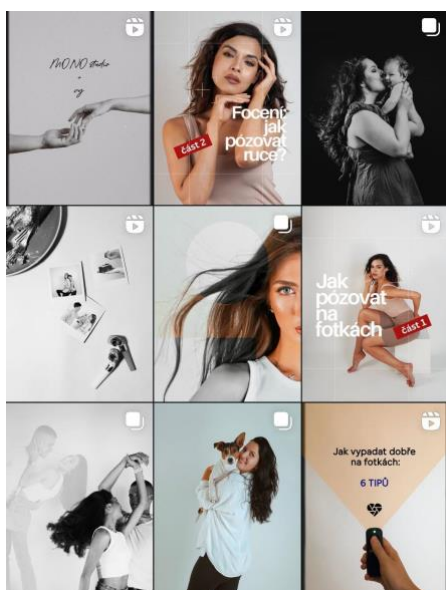
Self-service bar:

Visitors can enjoy a small treat before or after their session with our self-service bar. This thoughtful addition enhances the experience while building trust by giving customers the freedom to serve themselves

6) Who are your competitors?

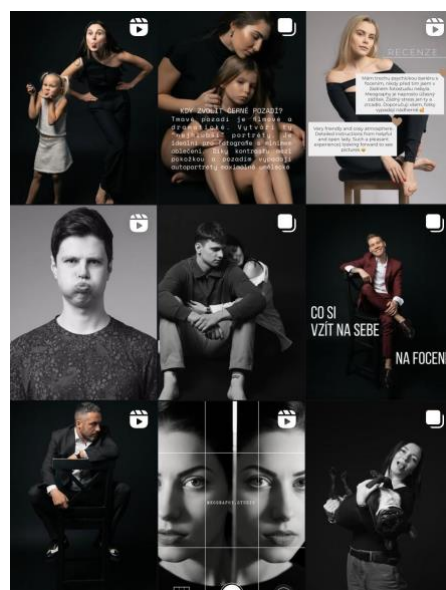
“Monostudio”, “Meography Studio”, “Magic Mirror” (see Figures 16 - 18)

Figure 17 Monostudio



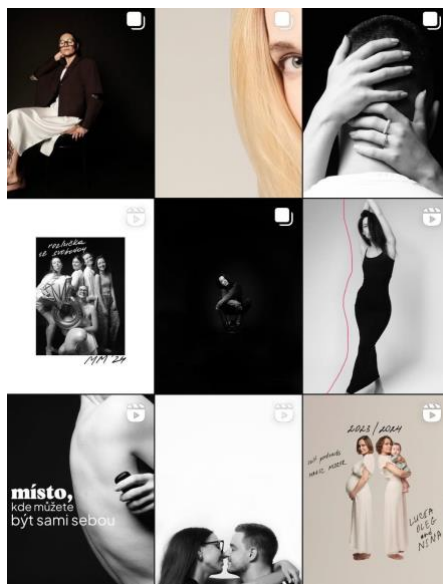
(@monostudio.cz, n.d.)

Figure 16 Meography Studio



(@meography.studio, n.d.)

Figure 18 Magic Mirror



(@magicmirror.prg, n.d.)

7) If your studio were a person, how would you describe its personality?

Vibrant, creative, modern, approachable, and trendy

8) What emotions do you want your brand identity to evoke?

Excitement, confidence, creativity, fun

9) Are there any styles, colors, or designs you want to avoid?

I don't want it to look unapproachable, too strict, too classy or corporate

10) Do you have anything I should consider before starting on your future visual identity?

I do not want to have an image of narcissus in a logo, I do not want it to be too complicated or too simple, I think an ideal variant will be a name "Narcis" or "Narcis Studio" written using an interesting font.

The brief provided detailed insights into the studio and the owner's vision for the future brand identity – modern, trendy, bright, and evoking positive emotions. The client aims to stand out from competitors, who predominantly focus on a black-and-white aesthetic, by creating a brand that is vibrant, modern, and approachable.

6 Creation of visual identities

As previously mentioned, this thesis will showcase the development of two visual identities to compare their effectiveness. The first identity will be designed with a use of psychological principles, as discussed in the theoretical section. This means the logo will follow Gestalt principles to enhance recognizability and coherence. Colors will be chosen based on their psychological impact and the emotions they evoke in the target audience. Typography will be carefully selected to match the intended emotional tone and brand message. Every design decision will be made with the audience's perception and engagement in mind.

The second identity, by contrast, will not follow these psychological guidelines. Instead, design choices will be made arbitrarily, without considering their psychological impact on the audience. Colors will be selected regardless of emotional or psychological associations, the logo will be created without applying Gestalt principles, and typography will not be strategically aligned with the business's image.

To ensure clear and measurable results, both A/B testing and questionnaire responses will be analyzed.

For the A/B testing on Instagram, key metrics such as number of views, click-through rate, number of followers gained and reach will be compared between the two profiles.

The questionnaire responses will be analyzed both quantitatively and qualitatively. Answers for closed multiple-choice questions will be examined to identify patterns in target audience

preference. Answers for open questions will be analyzed to uncover qualitative insights into why participants chose one identity over the other.

6.1 Visual identity based on psychological principles

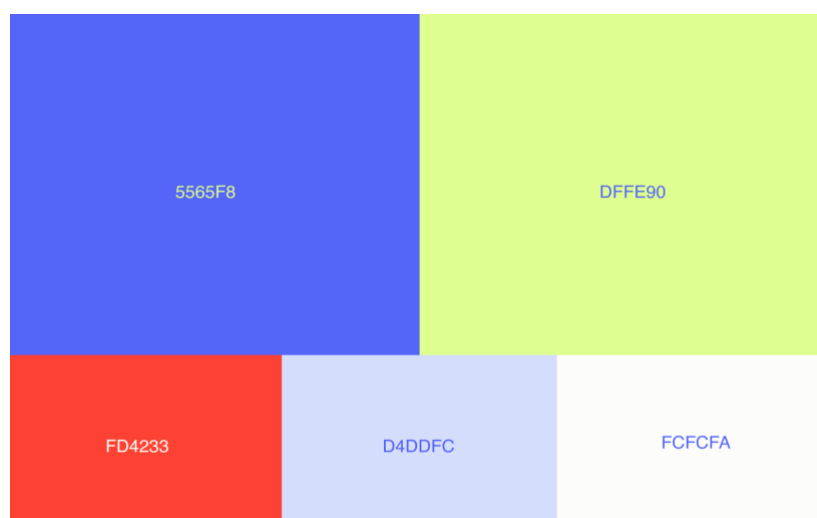
The first visual identity was created with a focus on psychological principles, as described in the theoretical part of the thesis, especially in the section *Effective visual brand identity*. During the design process, Gestalt principles were applied to the logo, a color scheme was created based on color psychology and the preferences of the target audience, and selected typography was chosen to be in line with the brand's tone and positioning. To test whether this psychology-based identity worked better than the non-strategic one, two methods will be applied later in the thesis: an A/B test on Instagram and a questionnaire. Both tools help to compare the two identities in terms of brand recall, emotional connection, and engagement.

6.1.1 Colors for the first visual identity

The first visual identity for Narcis Studio is designed with psychological principles in mind, starting with a carefully chosen color palette that resonates with the target audience – young adults aged 18 to 35 who live in urban areas and value self-expression and unique experiences. Research suggests that color plays a crucial role in brand perception, influencing emotions, associations, and decision-making processes (Labrecque & Milne, 2012).

For this identity, a combination of red, blue, green, and yellow was chosen to create a vibrant and engaging visual presence (see figure 19).

Figure 19 First visual identity – colors



(Kosheleva, 2025)

1. **Red - FD4233.** Linked to excitement, passion, and energy, red is usually used for capturing attention and encouraging action. It evokes confidence and boldness, highlighting the studio's message of self-love and importance of personal expression.
2. **Green - D7FF80.** The light green adds freshness, aligning with the studio's young audience. This hue is often connected with creativity and balance.
3. **Blue - 5565F8.** This color evokes associations with trust, reliability, and calmness. Blue enhances the studio's credibility and professional look, balancing the vibrant tones of the other colors.
4. **Light blue - D4DDFC.** This soft hue conveys a sense of serenity and openness, inviting visitors to feel comfortable, enhancing the overall welcoming atmosphere of the studio.
5. **White - FCFCFA.** This color often symbolizes purity and simplicity, providing a clean background that enhances the visibility of other colors.

The chosen color scheme is designed to be both visually striking and emotionally engaging, ensuring that the brand identity remains memorable and appealing. And the most important - it translates the message the studio aims to send to the potential customers – that the studio is a modern and bright place with a high energy vibe, targeting a younger creative audience.

6.1.2 Logo for the first visual identity

The second step was designing a logo based on Gestalt principles, which play a key role in visual perception and brand recognition. Gestalt psychology suggests that humans instinctively organize visual elements into unified wholes rather than perceiving them as separate parts (Interaction Design Foundation, n.d.). This approach makes the logo more memorable, visually balanced, and easily recognizable, aligning with the brand's goal of self-expression and individuality (see Figure 20).

Figure 20 First visual identity – logo



(Kosheleva, 2025)

These are the particular Gestalt Principles that were implied:

1. Figure-ground

The logo utilizes contrast between the bold blue typography and the light green background, ensuring high visibility and fast recognition. The spacing between the letters also enhances readability and allows the viewer to naturally differentiate the brand name from its background.

2. Closure

Gestalt's closure principle suggests that the human brain fills in missing visual information to perceive a complete form. The letters in the logo are partially open, yet the brain instinctively completes the missing spaces, making the logo more engaging and interactive. This subtle playfulness aligns with the brand's creative and modern identity.

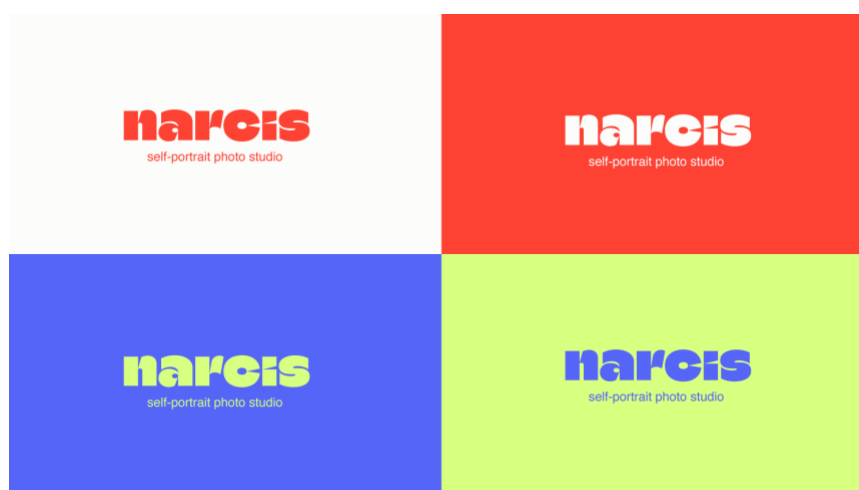
3. Proximity and similarity

The bold, rounded letters in the logo are spaced in a way that creates a sense of cohesion and unity. Gestalt's proximity principle states that elements placed close together are perceived as a group. This strengthens readability, ensuring the name "Narcis" is processed as a whole rather than individual letters.

4. Continuity

The smooth, rounded typography follows the continuity principle, guiding the viewer's eye naturally across the whole word "Narcis" (see Figure 21). This creates a sense of motion and flow, symbolizing the dynamic nature of the self-portrait studio.

Figure 21 First visual identity – logo in color variations

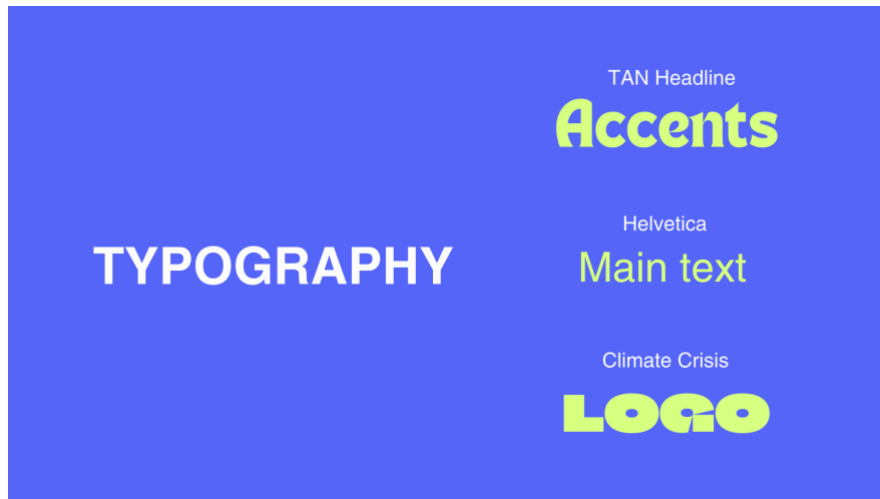


(Kosheleva, 2025)

6.1.3 Typography for the first visual identity

While designing the Narcis Studio brand identity, sans-serif typefaces were chosen to communicate modernity, simplicity, and approachability, as shown in Figure 22. Sans-serif fonts are widely recognized for their clean and contemporary aesthetic, making them particularly effective for brands that aim to engage young and creative people.

Figure 22 First visual identity – typography



(Kosheleva, 2025)

1. Logo typeface - Climate Crisis

The logo was based on the Climate Crisis font due to its bold, geometric structure, which creates a strong visual impact. The letters are rounded yet dynamic, contributing to the intended sense of energy and creativity.

2. Body text - Helvetica

For standard text, Helvetica was chosen because of its high legibility. Helvetica has long been associated with clarity and professionalism, making it an ideal choice for branding that requires a balance between modernity and reliability. Research suggests that sans-serif fonts enhance readability on digital screens, making Helvetica a good choice for a social-media-centric brand identity. By using Helvetica, the brand ensures that key information remains easy to read and digest.

3. Accent typeface - TAN Headline

TAN Headline is used as an accent font in key visuals for this version of visual identity. This typeface features high-contrast, expressive letterforms that enhance brand personality.

By using a mix of functional and expressive sans-serif fonts, the Narcis Studio visual identity achieves a modern, engaging, and accessible feel, resonating with its target audience of young adults who value self-expression and individuality.

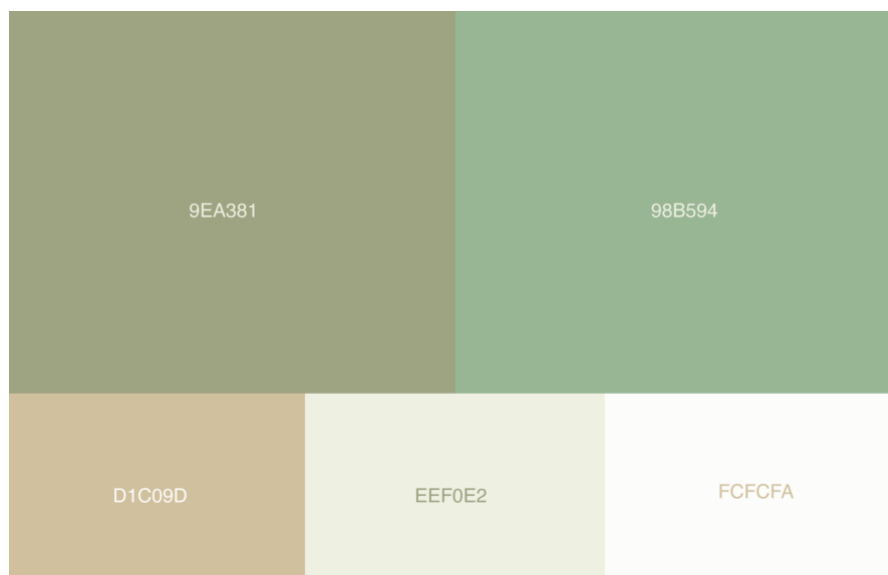
6.2 Visual identity that do not imply psychological principles

The second visual identity was created without applying psychological principles of branding. Unlike the first identity, which strategically incorporates color theory, typography psychology, and Gestalt principles to create a cohesive and engaging design, this version relies purely on aesthetic preferences without considering their psychological impact.

6.2.1 Colors for the second visual identity

The chosen colors – muted greens, beige, and soft pastels fail to evoke the intended emotions of confidence, self-expression, and excitement (see Figure 23).

Figure 23 Second visual identity – colors



(Kosheleva, 2025)

Instead, these green and brown hues are typically associated with nature, tranquility, and balance, while beige conveys neutrality and passivity. These associations create a calm and subdued mood, which does not align with the studio's goal of fostering self-expression and creativity.

The absence of high-contrast or dynamic colors further weakens the visual impact, making the brand feel less energetic and engaging to the target audience.

Research suggests that color plays a crucial role in brand perception and consumer behavior, and without a strategic selection based on psychological principles, there is a risk that this color scheme may not evoke the desired emotions or drive engagement as effectively as the psychology-based approach.

Moreover, the color palette shows more of the primary meaning of "Narcis" as a flower, demonstrating a botanical and nature-inspired visual rather than the intended concept of self-love and empowerment as a positive context of narcissism.

The floral motifs and pastel hues visually link the brand to traditional representations of narcissus, so that visual hues may be associated with a flower shop. However, the studio aims to redefine narcissism in a positive light, focusing on self-appreciation, self-exploration and individuality.

By using colors that are more commonly associated with nature and vintage aesthetics rather than contemporary self-expression, the identity creates an unintended disconnect between the brand's values and its visual representation.

6.2.2. Logo for the second visual identity

The logo in the second visual identity does not follow key branding principles. It uses the Biancha serif font, which has decorative, flowing letters that may look elegant but make the logo difficult to read (see Figure 24). Unlike the first logo, which follows Gestalt principles to improve memorability and balance, this design lacks simplicity and contrast, making it harder to recognize, especially in small sizes or on digital platforms like Instagram.

Figure 24 Second visual identity – logo



(Kosheleva, 2025)

The thin strokes reduce legibility, which is a major issue for branding. A good logo should be clear and easy to recognize immediately, but the complexity of this design may make it less effective.

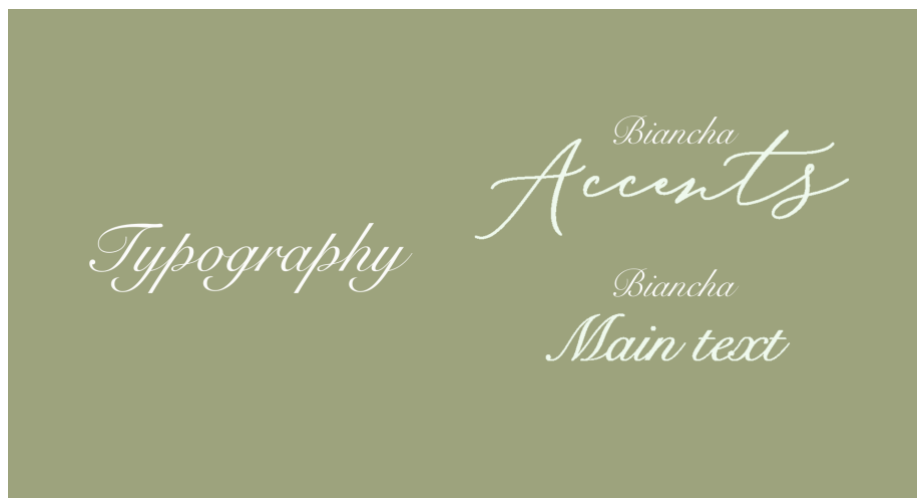
Additionally, the choice of this font shifts the brand's message away from self-love and personal expression toward a more traditional and nature-inspired theme. The studio wants to show "narcissism" in a positive way, yet this design reinforces the word's primary association with flowers rather than the intended theme.

Overall, this logo does not match the studio's modern and bold identity. Serif fonts are often linked to luxury, tradition, or romance, which do not reflect the vibrant and energetic personality of the brand. In contrast, the first visual identity's logo uses a strong, modern typeface that is clear, impactful, and aligned with the studio's goal of showing self-expression.

6.2.3 Typography for the second visual identity

The typography used in this visual identity relies on serif-based script fonts, including Snell Roundhand for main text elements (see Figure 25).

Figure 25 Second visual identity – typography



(Kosheleva, 2025)

While serif fonts are traditionally associated with elegance and formality, their effectiveness in digital applications, particularly on social media, is often questioned due to potential readability issues.

Unlike sans-serif fonts, which are widely used in digital because of their modern and clean look, script-based typography can appear overly decorative. As a result, this version of the visual identity may not effectively communicate the brand's core values or appeal to its intended audience.

Additionally, the inconsistent weight of the strokes in script fonts can create visual clutter, making text elements harder to read, especially in small sizes or on mobile devices. As a result, this typography choice may limit the accessibility and clarity of the brand's messaging, making it less effective for digital engagement.

7 A/B testing on Instagram

To compare two brand identities, two Instagram pages will be created – one showcasing the first visual identity and the other the second.

This method was chosen for several reasons:

1. The studio aims to be active on Instagram and use it as the primary platform for attracting new customers and engaging with them.
2. The target audience consists of young adults who are active on social media and often use Instagram not just for entertainment but also as a tool for discovering new businesses and services.
3. Running targeted ads will provide valuable insights, allowing for A/B testing of the same stories in terms of text and call to action but with different visuals, to determine which design resonates more with the audience.

Since Instagram does not allow identical usernames, the two accounts will have slightly different names:

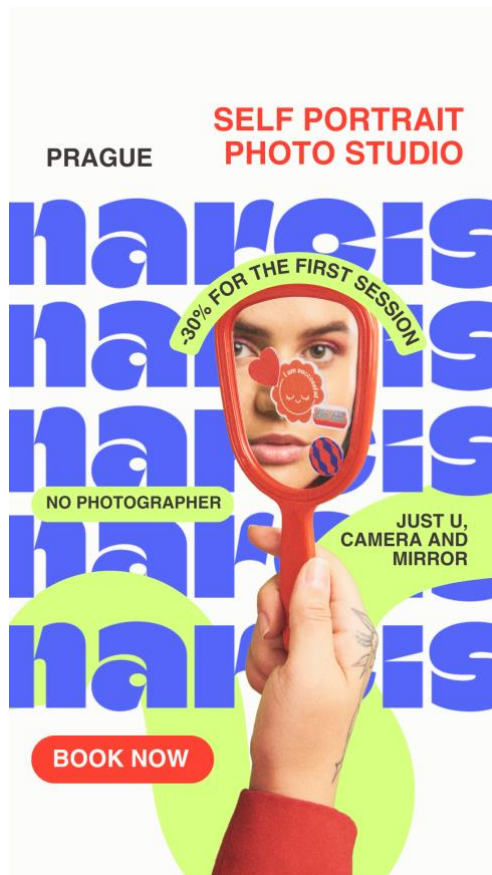
The first account will be named **narcis__studio**

The second account will be named **narcis__studio_**

The primary goal is to analyze Instagram stories of which visual identity generates more engagement and appeals more to the target audience. To measure this, Instagram Stories will be used, as they offer high visibility and engagement potential. The A/B test will be conducted over the same period of time, all other variables, such as stories texts, call to action and time of posting will be the same, the main difference will be in the visual look.

The designs made in line with each visual identity are shown in Figure 26 and Figure 27.

Figure 27 Design of an advertisement for the first visual identity



(Kosheleva, 2025)

Figure 26 Design of an advertisement for the second visual identity



(Kosheleva, 2025)

Figure 28 presents a bold and dynamic design, utilizing vibrant colors and large, attention-grabbing typography to create a modern and energetic aesthetic. The repetition of the brand name in the background reinforces brand recognition, while the green curvy lines add a sense of movement. The inclusion of the mirror as a key element visually communicates the self-portrait concept, clarifying the studio's unique offering. This design is expected to be seen as modern, dynamic, and aligned with the target audience – young, creative individuals who value self-expression.

In contrast, the second design shown in Figure 30 highlights what happens when branding decisions are made without considering psychological principles. The muted color palette and serif typography lack contrast and thus reduce readability – something crucial in digital environments. The narcissus imagery shifts the focus toward the literal meaning of "Narcis" as a flower rather than reinforcing the studio's message of self-love. The overall aesthetic is soft and passive, which does not align with the vibrant, confident identity the studio wants to have. It feels more like an advertisement for a flower shop, or a wellness retreat rather than a bold and modern self-portrait studio.

These campaigns were designed to target specific audience segments within Prague, focusing on individuals aged 18 to 35 who had interests in photography, travelling, dining out, social media, graphic design, and related creative fields (see Figure 28). This age group and interest profile were chosen based on the target audience indicated by the owner of the studio.

Figure 28 Instagram ad settings

Special requirements

Review if your ads are about financial products and services, employment, housing, social issues, elections or politics.

☐

Who should see your ad?

Suggested audience

Targets this ad to people similar to your followers

☐

Narcis Studio target audience

Advantage+ audience: On

Prague

Ages 18+

Suggestions: Men and women, ages 18+

[Edit](#)

☒

Create your own

Manually enter your targeting options

☐

Beneficiary and payer

When you create a new ad that is shown in the European Union, you need to tell us the person or organisation the ad is benefitting and the person or organisation paying for the ad. This information will be available in the Ad Library for a year but not on the ad itself. [Learn more](#)

Payment method

 Funds available: CZK0.00

[>](#)

We'll deduct funds about once a day when you run ads. If funds run out, your ads will be paused.

Payment summary

Your ad will run until you've paused it.

Daily budget	115.00 Kč
Estimated tax	\$0.00
Estimated daily amount	115.00 Kč

You're avoiding an Apple service fee by boosting on the web instead of the iOS app. [Learn more](#)

You won't be charged until your ad has been approved and starts running.

Note. Screenshot of ad statistics from the Narcis Studio’s Instagram account, March 2025.

Figure 29 Instagram ad settings

Edit audience

Interests [Edit](#)

Photograph (photography), Digital photography (photography), portrait photography (photography), Travel (travel and tourism), Graphic design (visual art), style and fashion (magazines), dining out (Restaurants), Social media marketing (marketing), socializing, Arts and music (art), Meetings, incentives, conferencing, exhibitions, Photographic studio, Modeling agency, influencer marketing (marketing), Photographer (photography), Online advertising (marketing), Digital marketing (marketing) or Content marketing (marketing)

Age 18 - 35 years old

Save

Note. Screenshot of ad statistics from the Narcis Studio's Instagram account, March 2025.

Each campaign had a daily budget of 115 CZK, with a total budget of 1,725 CZK over the 15-day testing period from March 10th to March 25th. This budgeting decision was made because of the need to allocate resources effectively and maximize visibility. The estimated reach of these campaigns was expected to be between 18,000 and 47,000 people. The targeting strategy also included adjustments based on user behavior and preferences captured through Instagram's Advantage+ audience tool, which helps refine ad delivery to those most likely to engage (see Figure 29 and Figure 30).

Figure 30 Instagram ad budget and duration

Instagram

Home Search Explore Reels Messages Notifications Create Dashboard Profile More

What's your ad budget?

1,725 Kč over 15 days **18,000-47,000**
Ad budget Estimated reach

Daily budget
Budget per day: 115 Kč

Duration
Run this ad until I pause it
Let your ad run for as long as you'd like. You can pause at any time in ad tools.

Set duration
Number of days: 15 days

Boost story

Ads are reviewed within 24 hours, although in some cases, it may take longer. Once they're running, you can pause spending at any time.

Note. Screenshot of ad statistics from the Narcis Studio's Instagram account, March 2025.

To effectively measure the impact of each visual identity, the campaigns will compare important engagement metrics such as views, profile visits, follows, and cost per profile visit. By running these ads simultaneously and under identical conditions, the experiment will provide insight into which visual identity resonates more with the target audience and generates higher engagement.

The strategic use of color, typography, and composition in the first design is expected to outperform the second, proving that a well-thought-out visual identity can significantly influence audience engagement and brand perception.

However, this method comes with certain assumptions and limitations. One key assumption is that Instagram engagement metrics, such as click-through rate and number of followers gained, serve as reliable indicators of audience preference for a particular visual identity. Another assumption is that the audience demographics for both accounts remain comparable, ensuring a fair evaluation.

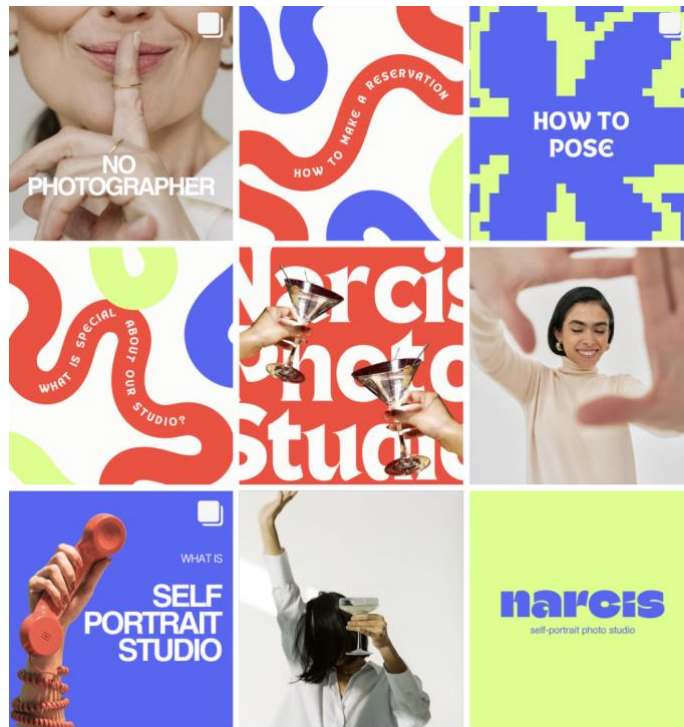
The limitations include potential variations in audience behavior due to differences in posting time and date, as well as fluctuations in Instagram's algorithm that may influence content visibility. Additionally, external factors, such as other marketing campaigns shown to the same audience at the same period of time could impact engagement rates. Despite efforts to maintain demographic consistency, variations in follower composition between the two accounts may also affect the results. Furthermore, since the studio is launching in May and the reservation system offers bookings from May, the advertisements running in March could influence the booking likelihood and the desire to follow the accounts. Also the fact that the studio's location has not yet been defined, may affect potential customers' willingness to commit to bookings two months in advance.

7.1 Instagram grids for both visual identities

Each Instagram grid was created reflecting the key visual elements for each of the two distinct visual identities created for Narcis Studio (see Figure 31 and Figure 32). All textual content, tone of voice, prices, and general information remains the same to isolate the impact of visual design differences. The primary distinction between the grids lies in their visual look, color use, and typography, which may significantly influence viewer perception and engagement.

Instagram grid for the first visual identity:

Figure 31 Instagram grid for the first visual identity



(Kosheleva, 2025)

The first grid features a bright and vibrant color scheme designed to capture attention and enhance visibility. High contrast between bright colors against lighter backgrounds makes texts easily readable and information quickly accessible.

This grid is designed to stand out and be immediately recognizable, showcasing bold colors that align with the energetic and creative vibe of Narcis Studio. The use of a modern, sans-serif font further enhances readability and adds to the contemporary feel of the grid, making it attractive for the target audience of the studio.

Instagram grid for the second visual identity:

In contrast, the second Instagram grid utilizes a muted color palette that lacks visual contrast, resulting in lower overall visibility of text and images. The chosen colors – subdued greens and earth tones are closely associated with nature and do not align with the vibrant, dynamic identity the studio seeks to show. This approach may cause the grid to blend into the background on social media feeds, where brighter, more contrasting colors typically dominate.

Figure 32 Instagram grid for the second visual identity



(Kosheleva, 2025)

Additionally, the use of an elegant, serif font in this grid might be associated with a traditional and sophisticated aesthetic, but it potentially reduces legibility especially in digital formats where clear, bold typefaces perform better.

Furthermore, the prevalent use of floral and nature motifs reinforces the primary, botanical meaning of the word 'narcis,' which the studio explicitly aims to move away from, potentially confusing the brand's message which is focused on self-love and appreciation.

It is expected that the first Instagram profile will outperform the second one because of its visuals.

7.2 Results of A/B testing on Instagram

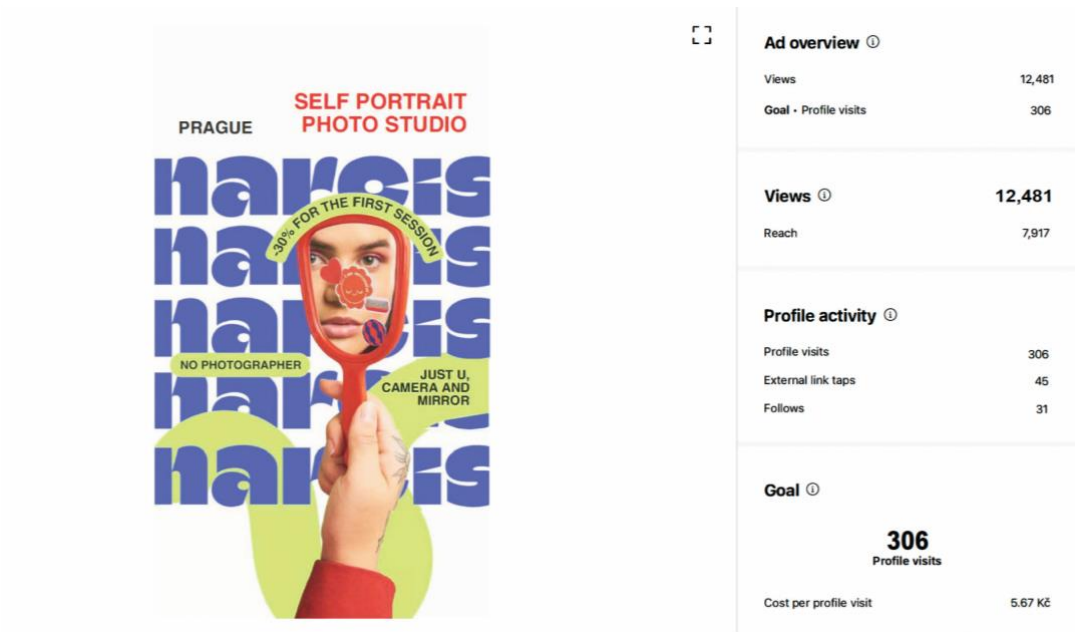
Two Instagram Story ads were tested for 15 days (from the 10th of March to 25th of March) with the same audience, identical budgets, ad texts and call to action. The key difference between them was their visual identity: one was created using psychology-based principles (bold colors, strong typography, high contrast, that resonated with the young audience of the self-portrait studio that positions itself as a creative and modern space), while the other relied on a traditional, nature-inspired design, that was not made taking into account Gestalt principles, color psychology and specific preferences of the young target audience in

typography; muted green tones, floral visuals, elegant serif typography were used and the whole design were more connected to the primary meaning of the word “narcis”, rather than the desired message of showing narcissism as self-love.

The psychology-based ad (showcased on Figure 33) significantly outperformed the non-psychology-based one across all metrics (showcased on Figure 34).

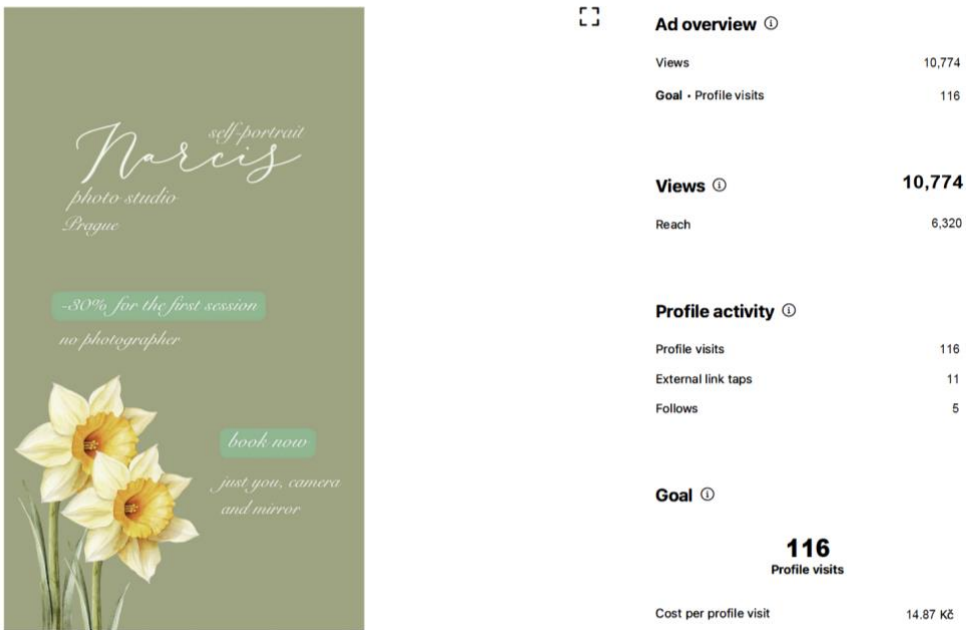
It resulted in 306 profile visits, compared to 116 – an increase of 164%. The number of external link clicks was also much higher, with 45 clicks versus 11, representing a 309% improvement. Follower growth showed the most dramatic gap: 31 follows for the psychology-based ad compared to only 5 follows for the alternative design, meaning a 520% increase (see the Figure 32 and Figure 33).

Figure 33 First Instagram ad results



Note. Screenshot of ad statistics from the Narcis Studio’s Instagram first account, March 2025.

Figure 34 Second Instagram ad results



Note. Screenshot of ad statistics from the Narcis Studio’s Instagram second account, March 2025.

In terms of reach and exposure, the psychology-based ad reached 7,917 users and gained 12,481 views, while the other one ad reached 6,320 users and earned 10,744 views. While the view and reach difference is smaller, the engagement data clearly shows that users responded more actively to the psychology-driven design.

These results suggest that visual identity built around psychological principles, such as color psychology, contrast, and visual hierarchy has a better impact on user behavior. It not only captures attention but also leads to more profile visits, clicks, and follower growth. This A/B test supports the core idea of this thesis: applying psychology to branding can significantly improve both engagement and conversion rates for the brand.

7.3 Limitations of A/B testing on Instagram

The A/B testing on Instagram gave useful data about real user behavior, but it comes with some set of limitations.

Although both ads were run under the same conditions (same text, audience, budget, and duration), Instagram’s algorithm may still influence ad performance in ways that are not fully transparent, such as tiny changes in how often each ad is shown.

Furthermore, while the test measured engagement metrics like clicks and follows, it didn’t capture deeper reasoning behind those actions, which means we can't fully understand why users responded better to one design over the other without further qualitative feedback.

Also, the test ran for 15 days because of the limited budget, which is long enough to collect basic data, but a longer campaign might give even clearer patterns.

Instagram ads are viewed on a range of devices with different screen sizes, resolutions, and color settings. This may affect how colors and typography appear, possibly influencing engagement in ways unrelated to the design itself. Moreover, the test was conducted using Instagram Story ads only. Other formats like feed posts, reels, or carousels could perform differently and may offer a broader picture of how visual identity affects user behavior.

During the testing period, external influences like time of day, day of the week, other content, or even personal mood can influence whether a user engages with an ad, making it harder to isolate design as the only factor.

Although both ads targeted the same audience, some users may have seen both variants. This overlap might have influenced their reaction to one based on the memory of the other, reducing the independence of each ad's performance.

8 Questionnaire

The questionnaire is an important part of A/B testing of two distinct visual identities made for the same self-portrait studio. It would help to determine which of the two visual identities for Narcis Studio resonates more with the target audience. Since branding is about perception and emotional connection, this survey is designed to capture how people react to different design elements – logos, colors, typography, and overall look of both visual identities. It will provide real feedback on which visual identity makes a brand identity feel more engaging, memorable, and trustworthy.

Participants will be shown two visual identities: one designed using psychological principles (Variant A) and another created without these considerations (Variant B). The questions are structured to measure brand recognition, emotional impact, and engagement potential. Some questions ask for a simple choice between the two identities, while others use a rating scale to measure trust and appeal. Open-ended questions are included to understand why participants prefer one version over the other.

The questionnaire is split into sections, starting with basic demographic questions to understand who the respondents are. Then, it moves on to test brand recall, asking which identity stands out more at first glance and which feels more modern or inviting. The next section goes deeper into specific elements – how colors and typography influence perception, which logo feels more readable, and which identity participants would be more likely to follow or engage with on social media.

To test how memorable the branding is over time, a short follow-up questionnaire will be sent two days later for the participants who agreed to fill in the second questionnaire. This will help assess which visual identity was more memorable and whether their initial preference remains the same. By combining immediate reactions with delayed recall, this research will provide a well-rounded view of how branding choices influence audience perception and engagement.

This questionnaire will run for the same duration as the Instagram ads, from March 10th to March 25th, ensuring that data is collected under the same conditions as the social media campaign.

8.1 Questionnaire overview

The questionnaire was designed by the author for the purposes of this thesis. Its structure was based on the research questions, the brand positioning of Narcis Studio, and key psychological and branding principles discussed in the theoretical part. The aim was to gather insights about how people perceive two different visual identities (one based on psychology, the other not) and to evaluate brand recall, emotional response, and engagement potential.

The questionnaire consisted of five sections and a total of 28 questions. It combined various question types, including:

- Multiple choice questions
- Likert-scale ratings (e.g., rating trust or credibility on a 1-5 scale)
- Open-ended questions (to explore why participants made certain choices)

This mix allowed for both quantitative analysis (for example, preference rates, emotion associations, trust scores) and qualitative insights (for example, reasoning behind logo preference or emotional connection).

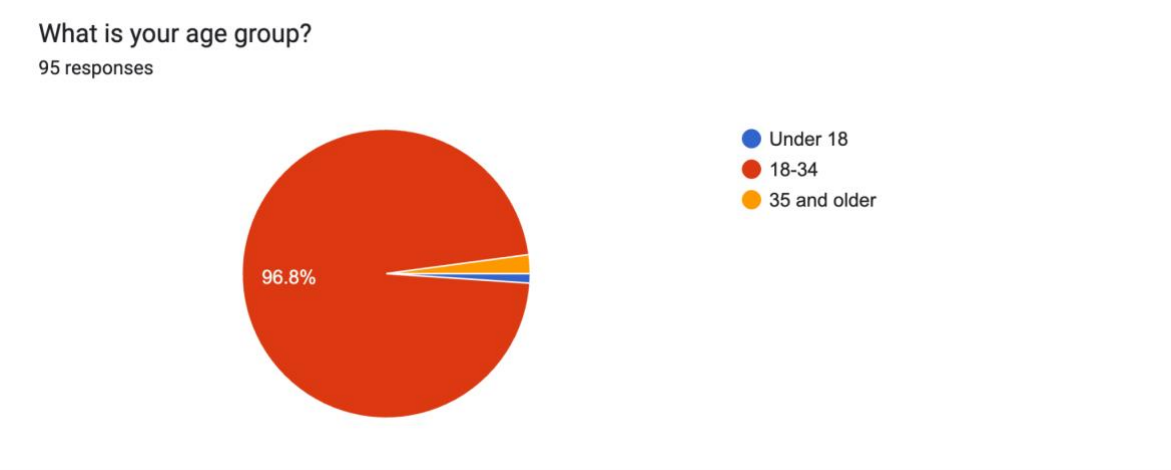
The responses to closed questions were analyzed by calculating how many participants chose each option. The results were presented as percentages and rating summaries to show which visual identity was preferred and how strongly. Answers to open-ended questions were grouped thematically to identify repeated patterns and justifications. These insights helped explain the emotional and cognitive reasons behind the participants' choices and added depth to the gathered data.

The questionnaire was distributed online through social media and personal networks of the author (Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook), targeting people who fit the demographic and psychographic profile of Narcis Studio's audience. In total, 95 participants completed the questionnaire. Among them:

- 96.8% were aged 18–34 (see Chart 1)
- 96.4% lived in urban areas (see Chart 2)
- over 60% had experience with photography or design (either professionally or as a hobby) (see Chart 3)

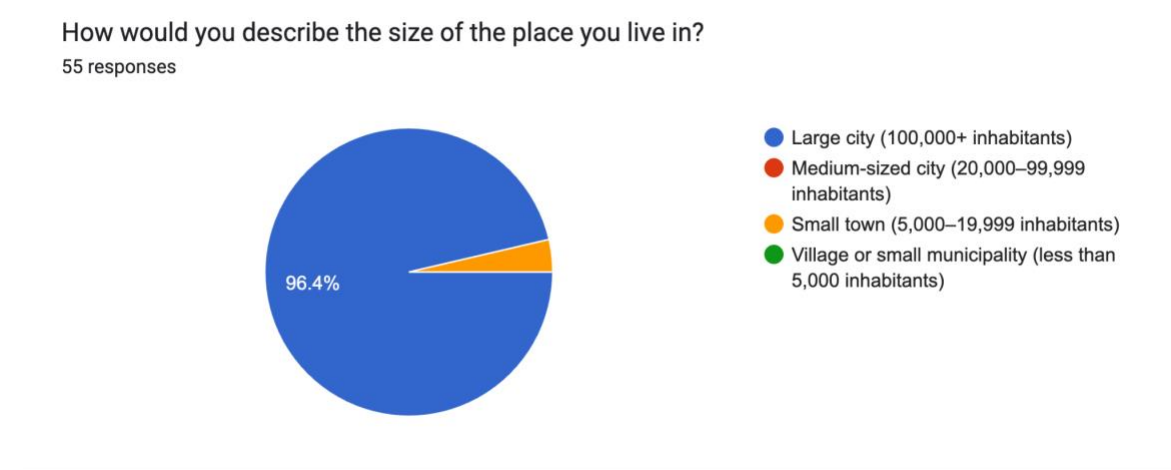
These characteristics closely match the defined target audience of Narcis Studio: young, creative individuals living in cities, who are active on social media and value unique experiences. Therefore, the sample is aligned with the intended audience of the brand and relevant for testing the effectiveness of the visual identities.

Chart 1 Questionnaire first section. Question 1



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

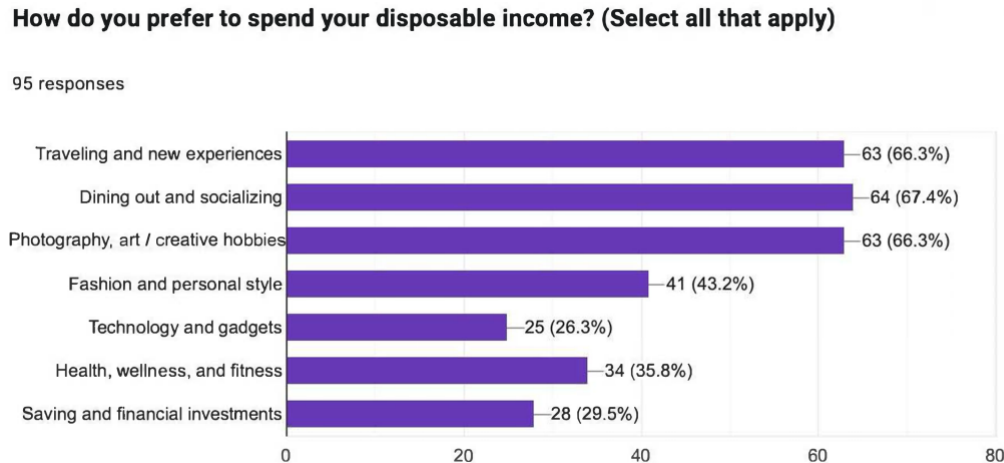
Chart 2 Questionnaire first section. Question 2



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Beyond basic demographics, the respondents answer a question concerning their lifestyle. The majority reported that they prefer to spend their disposable income on traveling and new experiences (66.3%), creative hobbies like photography and art (66.3%), and social activities such as dining out (67.4%). These findings match with the studio’s positioning, which aims to attract consumers who prefer to spend their money on new experiences rather than getting material things (see Graph 1).

Graph 1 Questionnaire first section. Question 3



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

The demographic profile and lifestyle patterns of the respondents from this questionnaire confirm that this sample is suitable to evaluate how the studio's distinct visual identities and design choices resonate with the intended audience.

8.1.1 Result of the first section of the questionnaire

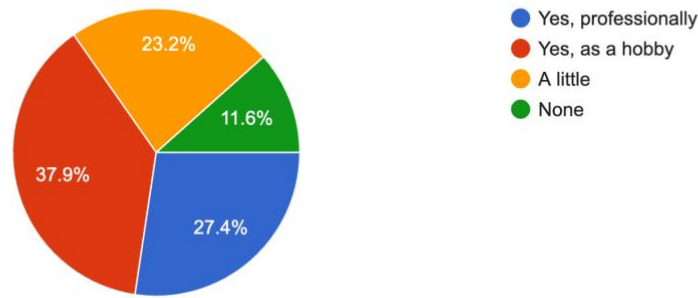
The first section of the questionnaire was focused on who the respondents are and how much visual identity influences their potential decision-making. As was mentioned before, nearly 97% of participants fall into the category of 18-34 years old (see Chart 1). Furthermore, 96% of respondents live in big urban areas (see Chart 2) where brands often want to differentiate from other brands visually. This finding confirms that Narcis Studio’s visual strategy will be evaluated by a city-based, trend-conscious audience. The sample of respondents fits perfectly with the audience that the brand wants to target.

Interestingly, over 60% of participants also have a background in design or photography, either professionally or as a hobby. It suggests a respondents' level of visual literacy that makes their feedback on visual identities and its elements more relevant (see Chart 3).

Chart 3 Questionnaire first section. Question 4

Do you have any previous experience with photography or design?

95 responses



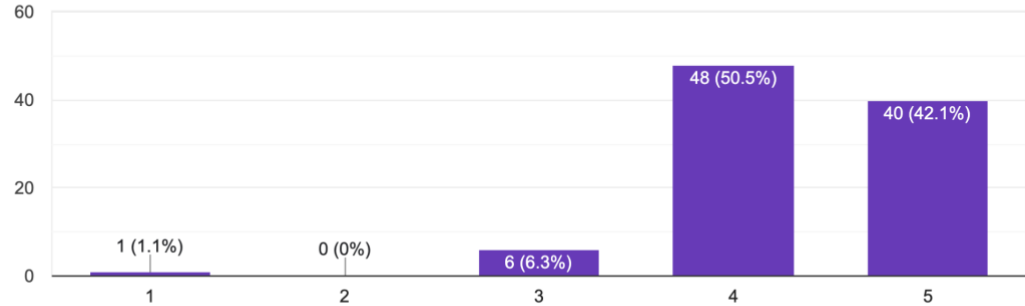
Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

The section also confirmed an assumption of this thesis: for the majority of respondents, visual identity plays a critical role in decision-making. More than 90% indicated that design has a strong influence – rating it 4 or 5 out of 5 (see Graph 2), and over 80% said branding would specifically impact their decision in choosing a self-portrait studio (see Graph 3).

Graph 2 Questionnaire first section. Question 5

How much does the visual identity (logo, colors, typography, and overall design) of a brand influence your decision to choose a service or product?

95 responses

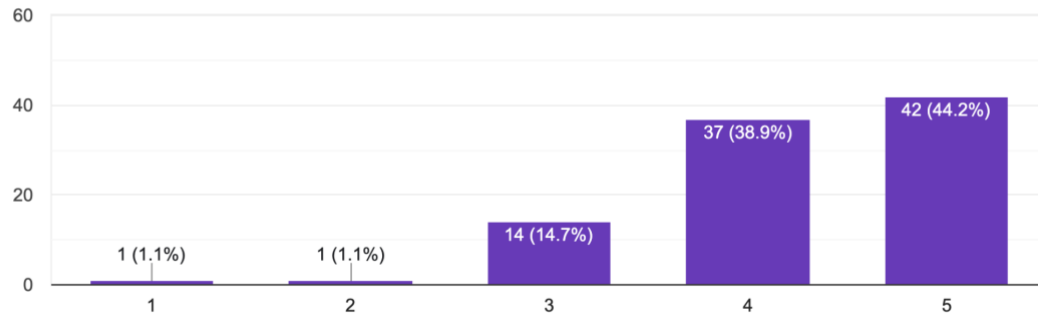


Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Graph 3 Questionnaire first section. Question 6

If you were choosing a self-portrait studio, would the branding influence your decision to book a session?

95 responses



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

In summary, the first section of the questionnaire confirms that the target audience is highly receptive to branding. It also reinforces the importance of applying psychological principles in design to create identities that resonate with the psychological aspect and target audience, which is the core of this thesis.

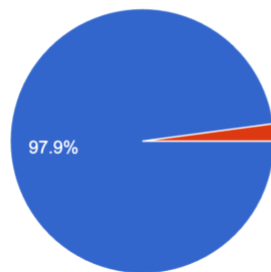
8.1.2 Result of the second section of the questionnaire

The second section of the questionnaire focuses on how respondents emotionally connect with each of the two visual identities and how they perceive their elements. Starting with **memorability**, Variant A outperformed Variant B in both questions on short and long-term memorability (see Chart 4 and Chart 5). In contrast, Variant B was perceived as less likely to hold attention over time.

Chart 4 Questionnaire second section. Question 1

Which visual identity is more memorable at first glance?

95 responses



☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B

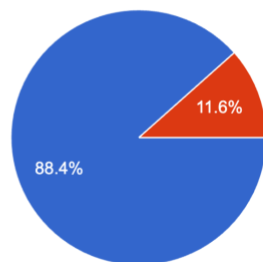


Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Chart 5 Questionnaire second section. Question 2

Which visual identity do you believe would appeal to you even after extended use?

95 responses



☐ Variant A



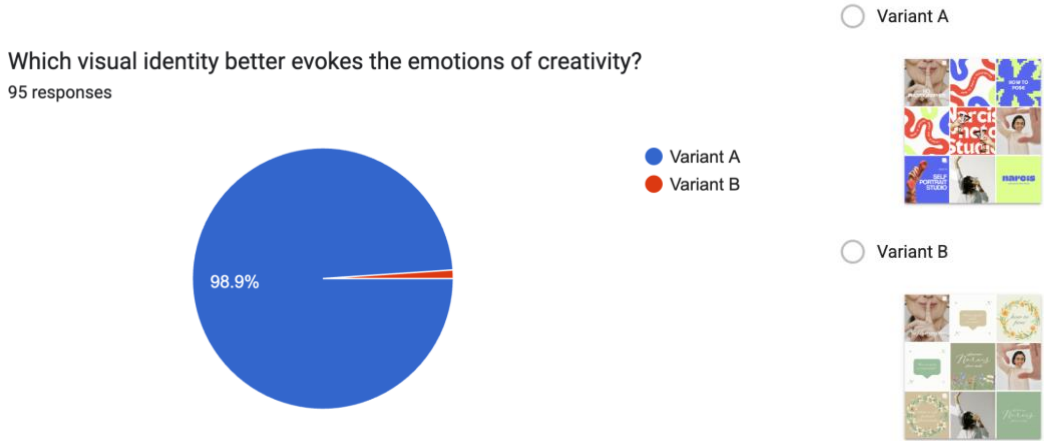
☐ Variant B



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

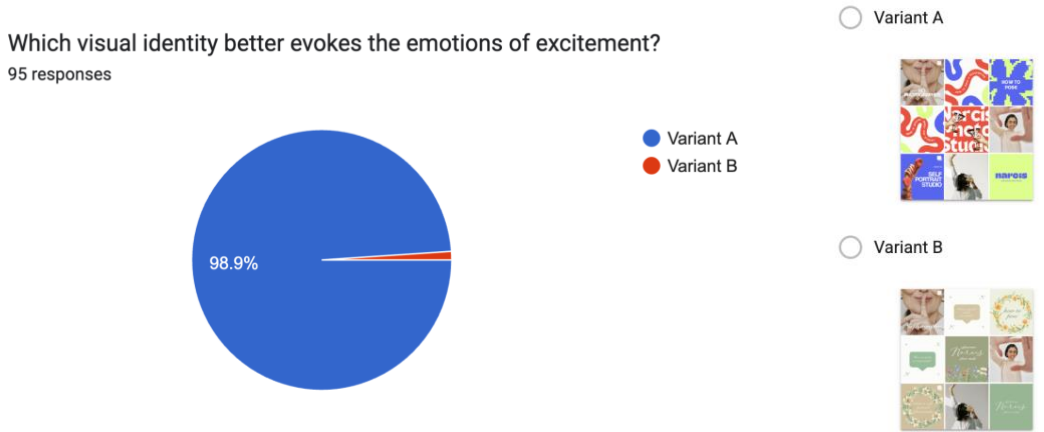
Speaking about the **emotional aspects**, 98.9% of participants selected Variant A as the visual identity that better evokes feelings of **creativity** (see Chart 6), and the same number linked it to **excitement** (see Chart 7). Similarly, when asked which design evokes **confidence**, 93.7% chose Variant A (see Chart 8). This suggests that the psychology-driven visual identity resonates on a deeper emotional level with the audience, demonstrating the key brand values of Narcis Studio: creativity, confidence, and excitement.

Chart 6 Questionnaire second section. Question 3



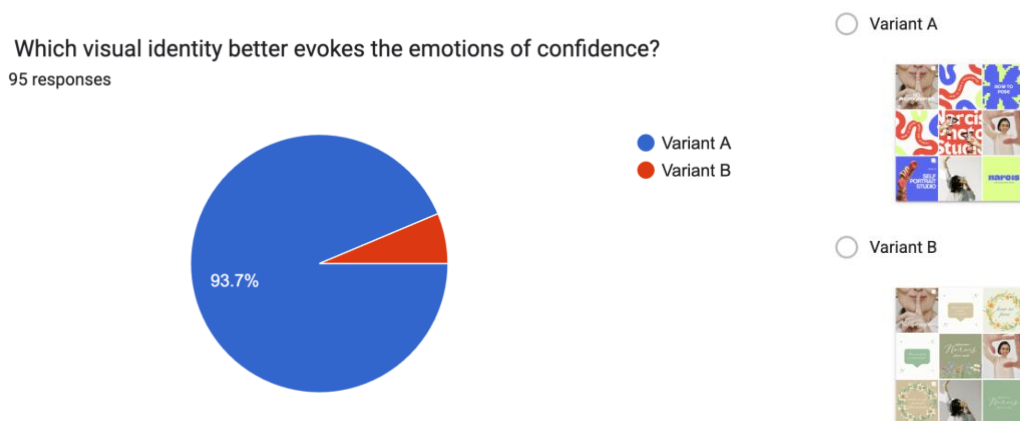
Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Chart 7 Questionnaire second section. Question 4



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

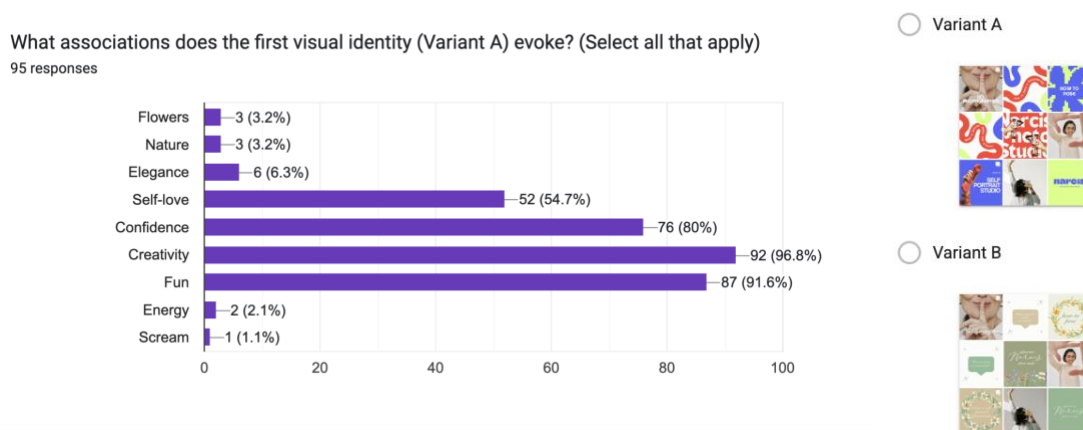
Chart 8 Questionnaire second section. Question 5



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

When the respondents were asked about the **specific emotions each of the visual identities evoked**, answers for Variant A were similar to what the brand wants to be associated with (see Graph 4) – the most popular answers were Creativity (96.8%), Fun (91.6%) and Confidence (80%). Variant B, in contrast, was mostly associated with Flowers (88.4%), Nature (85.3%) and Elegance (55.8%) (see Graph 5). The results prove that the psychology-based visual identity evokes the intended emotions, while the other does not.

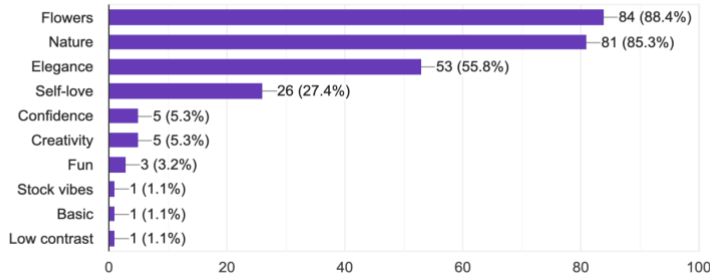
Graph 4 Questionnaire second section. Question 6



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Graph 5 Questionnaire second section. Question 7

What associations does the first visual identity (Variant B) evoke? (Select all that apply)
95 responses



☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B

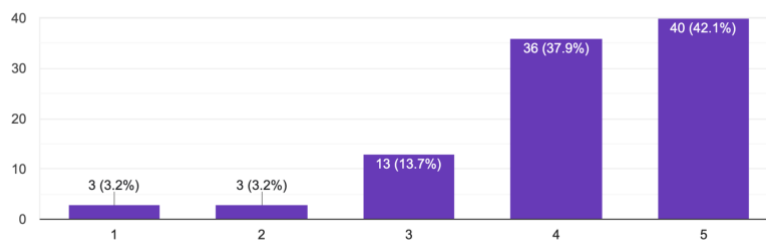


Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Further insights come from trust ratings tied to the **color schemes**. Variant A's palette gained high trust ratings from 80% of respondents – with ratings of 4 or 5, out of 5 (see Graph 6), while Variant B had the majority of ratings around 1 and 2 (see Graph 7).

Graph 6 Questionnaire second section. Question 8

On a scale of 1-5, how much do you trust each brand based on its color scheme? (Variant A)
95 responses



☐ Variant A

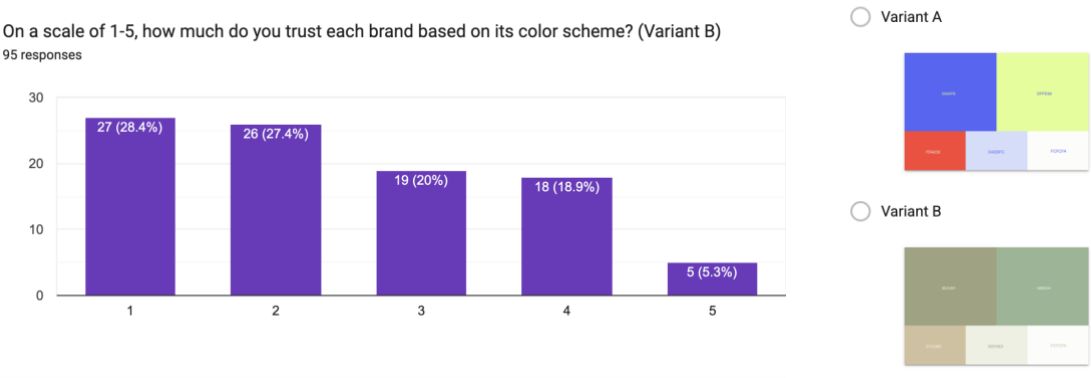


☐ Variant B



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

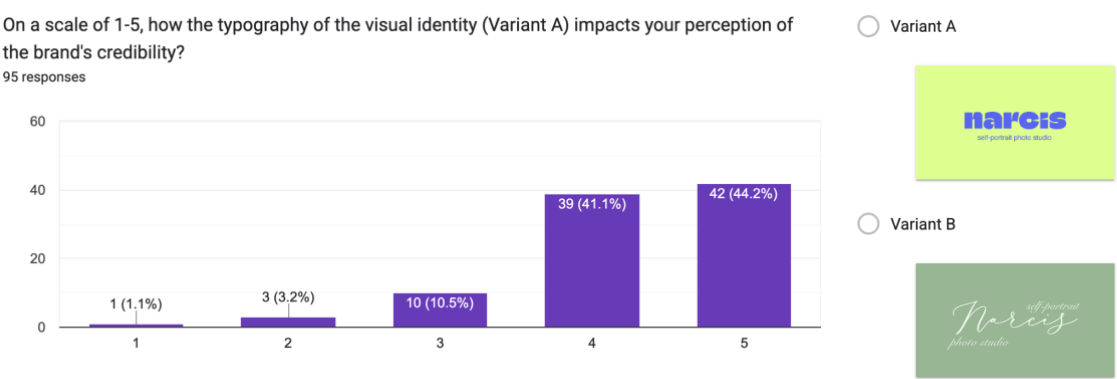
Graph 7 Questionnaire second section. Question 9



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Typography results show a similar situation. Participants rated Variant A’s **typography** as more credible, with 85% giving it a 4 or 5, while Variant B’s typography was rated as less reliable and less fitting for a modern, creative brand (see Graph 8).

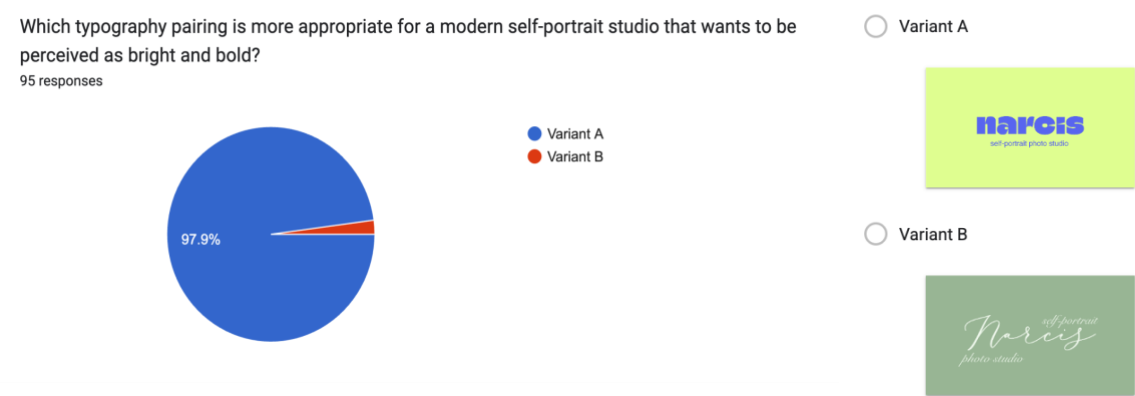
Graph 8 Questionnaire second section. Question 10



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

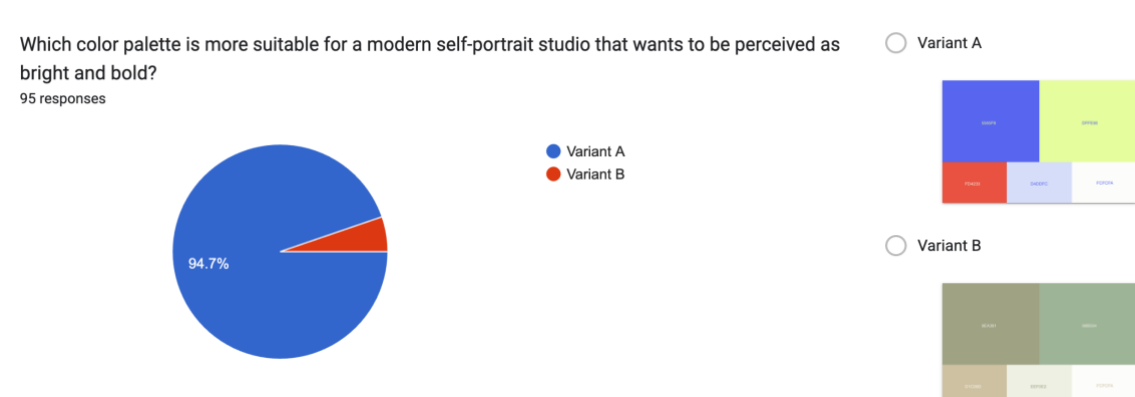
In general, **both** the **color palette** and the **typography** pairings for the visual identity A were chosen as **more suitable** for a modern self-portrait studio that wants to be perceived as **bright** and **bold** (See Chart 9 and Chart 10).

Chart 9 Questionnaire second section. Question 11



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

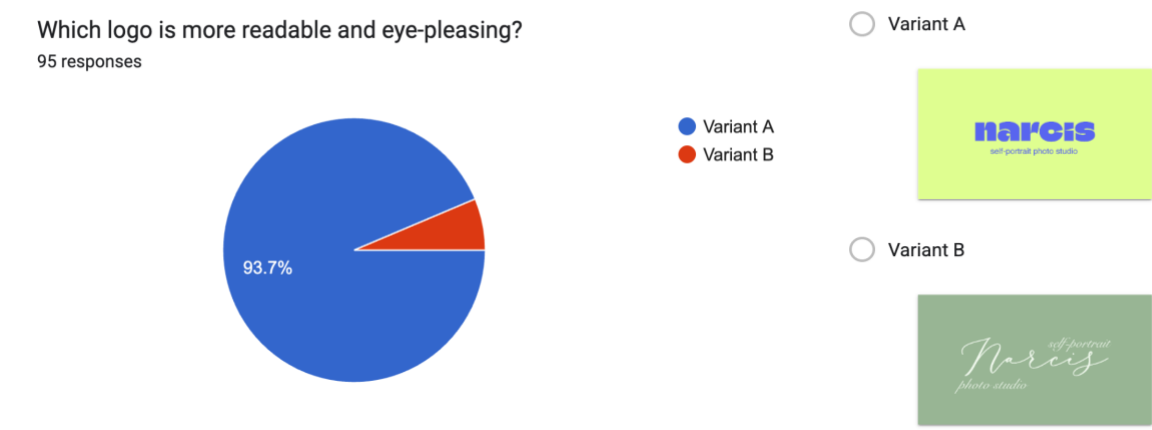
Chart 10 Questionnaire second section. Question 12



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

One of the key questions was which **logo** participants found **more readable and visually appealing**. The results showed that about 94% of respondents favored Variant A, and only about 6% of the respondents gave preference to Variant B. This tells us that the logo from the Variant A resonated with respondents in terms of clarity and overall look (see Chart 11)

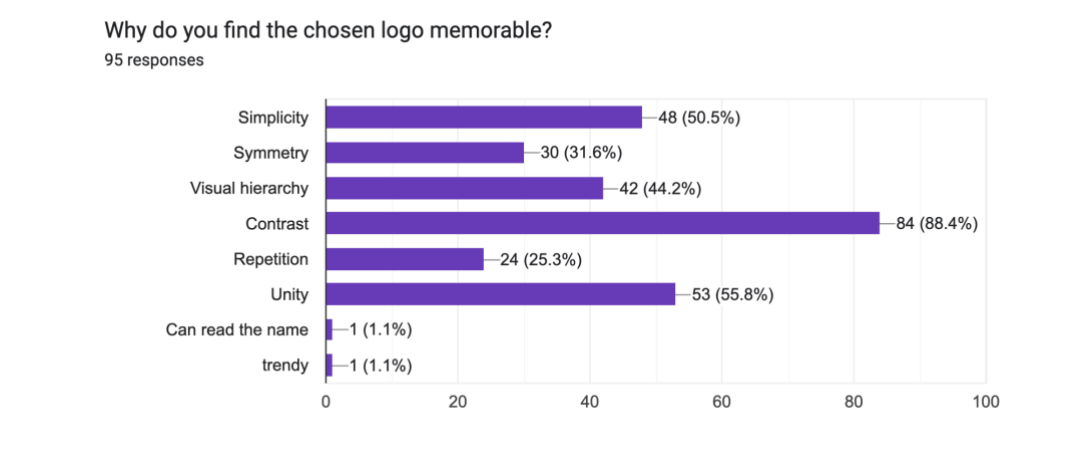
Chart 11 Questionnaire second section. Question 13



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Participants were also asked to explain **why** they found their chosen **logo memorable**. The most common reasons given for choosing Variant A centered around key Gestalt principles – contrast, visual hierarchy, unity, simplicity (see Graph 9).

Graph 9 Questionnaire second section. Question 14



Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

The majority (88.4%) highlighted that Variant A has strong contrast, making it stand out and easier to process quickly. Unity (55.8%) and simplicity (50.5%) were also major factors. Respondents appreciated that Variant A had a clean, cohesive feel that felt both modern and professional. Other elements like visual hierarchy (44.2%) and symmetry (31.6%) also played supporting roles in how people perceived the logo.

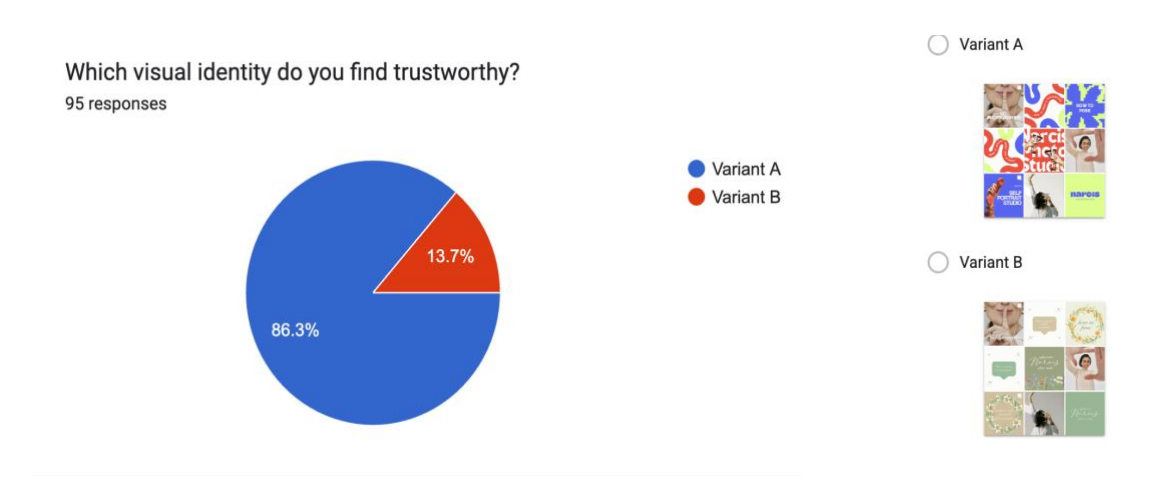
Overall, this section clearly supports the thesis claim: applying psychological design principles, such as using color theory, contrast, and visual hierarchy, can help to create a visual identity that resonates more effectively on an emotional and cognitive level. The results confirm that a strategic, psychology-based approach helped strengthen brand memorability, trust, evoke the expected emotional responses, and create a more engaging identity for young urban audiences.

8.1.3 Result of the third section of the questionnaire

The third section of the questionnaire aimed to capture how each visual identity affects respondents on an emotional and psychological level. According to the results Variant A outperformed Variant B across all questions again.

Starting with trustworthiness, 86% of respondents found Variant A more **trustworthy** than Variant B (see Chart 12).

Chart 12 Questionnaire third section. Question 1



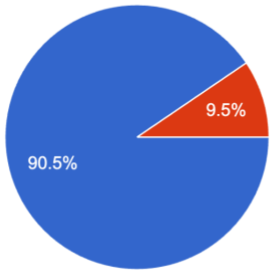
Note. Data collected from the author’s primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

In the open-ended questions many respondents pointed out that Variant A felt more "professionally crafted," "precise," and aligned with the studio’s positioning as a creative, modern space. Several participants mentioned that Variant B gave them a "dated" or "generic" vibe, sometimes even comparing it to “old-fashioned flower studios” or "template designs." In contrast, Variant A’s brighter colors and well-thought-out typography were perceived as more in tune with a photo studio aiming to feel fresh and bold (see open-ended answers in the Attachment A).

When asked which **color scheme better fits the mood** of a self-portrait studio, 90.5% of respondents again preferred Variant A (see Chart 13). Open-ended responses mentioned *"chosen colors of design – looks unique, bright and eye-catching"*, describing it similar to the Narcis' desired positioning. A few comments stood out, like one saying that Variant A *"depicts bright colors and nice typography which fits the image of a photo-studio,"* highlighting that this color scheme didn't just attract attention but goes along with the studio description (see open-ended answers in the Attachment A).

Chart 13 Questionnaire third section. Question 2

Which color evokes emotions that fit that self-portrait studio?
95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B



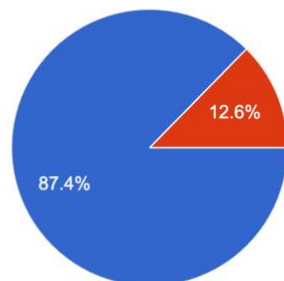
Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Some respondents also pointed out a psychological link between attention to visual detail and the assumption that the brand itself will offer quality service. *"If a brand cares about visuals, it probably cares about everything else,"* one person noted, hinting at how design elements influence deeper perceptions of reliability (see open-ended answers in the Attachment A). Emotionally, Variant A fostered a much **stronger connection**, according to 87.1% of respondents (see Chart 14).

Chart 14 Questionnaire third section. Question 3

Which visual identity gives you a stronger emotional connection?

95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B



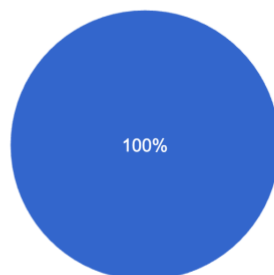
Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Interestingly, all 95 respondents answered that Variant A looked more **modern** (see Chart 15) and 96,5% said that Variant A is **more suitable in general** for the Narcis self-portrait studio description (see Chart 16).

Chart 15 Questionnaire third section. Question 4

Which brand identity feels more modern?

95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant B

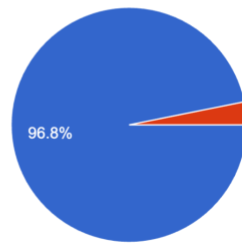


Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025

Chart 16 Questionnaire third section. Question 5

Which brand identity feels more aligned with a modern self-portrait studio that wants to be perceived as bright and bold?

95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

The findings from the third section confirm that Variant A does not only perform better visually but also builds a stronger emotional connection and greater sense of trust among respondents. The modern design, bright color scheme, and thoughtful use of typography clearly aligned with the audience's expectations for a modern self-portrait photo studio. In contrast, Variant B was often seen as outdated and mismatched with the brand's purpose. Overall, the results of this section support the idea that applying psychological design principles can significantly shape how a brand is perceived on both a visual and emotional level.

8.1.4 Result of the fourth section of the questionnaire

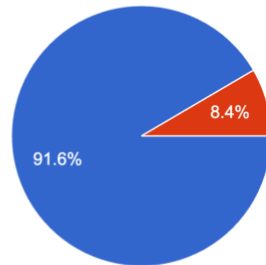
The fourth section of the questionnaire was made to understand how visual identity influences engagement and brand preference on social media, particularly focusing on the intention to possibly follow, book a session and interact with both accounts. The answers show a strong preference for Variant A across all categories.

Firstly, when asked which visual identity would make the respondents **more likely to book a session** at the studio, 91.4% of participants selected Variant A. This finding demonstrates that Variant A is not only visually appealing but can convert visual attraction into specific consumer action. This proves that effective branding goes beyond aesthetics and directly impacts purchasing behavior (see Chart 17).

Chart 17 Questionnaire fourth section. Question 1

Which visual identity would make you more likely to book a session at the studio?

95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant A



☐ Variant B



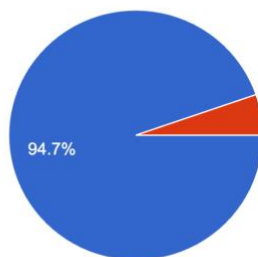
Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Secondly, when asked which identity's Instagram content feels **more engaging and visually compelling**, 94.6% of respondents chose Variant A. This indicates that Variant A corresponds with modern expectations for social media content. (see Chart 18).

Chart 18 Questionnaire fourth section. Question 2

Which visual identity's Instagram content feels more engaging and visually compelling?

95 responses



● Variant A
● Variant B

☐ Variant A



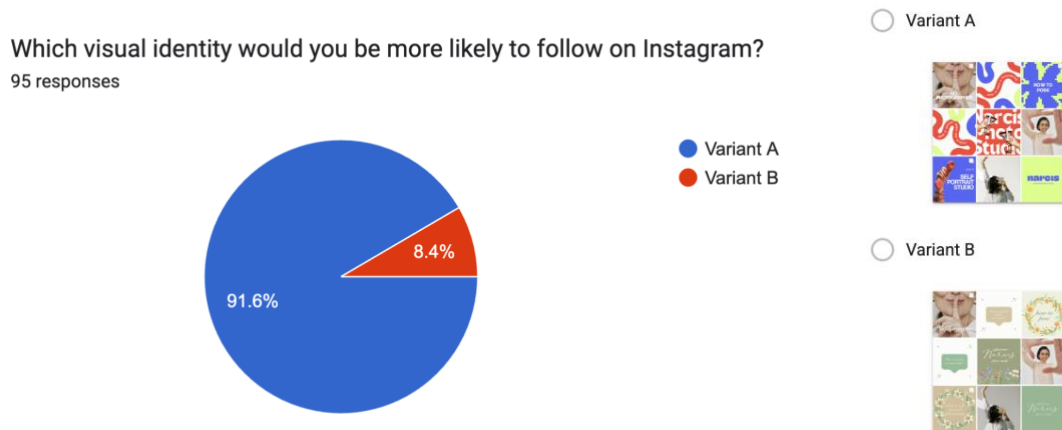
☐ Variant B



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

A similar pattern appears when participants were asked which visual identity, they would be more **likely to follow on Instagram**, with 91.4% again selecting Variant A (see Chart 19).

Chart 19 Questionnaire fourth section. Question 3



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

The combination of this data suggests that Variant A not only visually attracts respondents but has the potential to gain new followers, which is important for a self-portrait studio targeting a young audience.

Some participants in open-ended responses explicitly mentioned that Variant A would drive them to follow the studio's Instagram account, describing it as visually inspiring and of high-quality. Comments such as *"I would definitely follow Instagram with the visual identity A"* and *"this high-quality content will bring this studio a lot of customers who value good design"* suggest a perception of Variant A as trustworthy (see Figure 35).

Figure 35 Answers for an open-ended question in the fourth section

Is there anything else that comes to your mind regarding this section that you would like to share?

You can answer in either English or Czech.

2 responses

I would defo follow the Instagram with the visual identity A

I find this design really inspiring and I think this high-quality content will bring this studio a lot of customers who value good design

Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

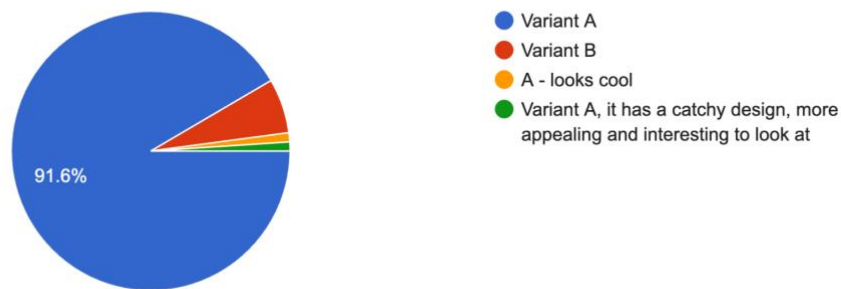
In summary, this section of the questionnaire confirms that a strong, well-executed visual identity significantly increases the likelihood of potential customer engagement. Variant A is perceived as modern, engaging, and capable of driving not only social media interaction but also actual bookings. These insights strengthen the argument that psychological and emotional factors in design directly influence customer behavior, proving why focusing on applying branding psychology to visual identity creation is important.

8.1.5 Result of the fifth section of the questionnaire

The final section of the questionnaire was made to get participants' overall impressions and preferences of the two visual identity variants. The results strongly favored Variant A, with 91.6% of respondents selecting it as their overall preferred identity (See chart 20).

Chart 20 Questionnaire fifth section. Question 1

Which visual identity do you prefer overall?
95 responses



Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

When asked to explain their preference, participants frequently chose qualities such as modernity, creativity, and visual appeal as key reasons behind their choice. Many respondents described Variant A as *“bright colors, creative design”* and noted that it *“suits the decisions of a modern studio, reflects its characteristics”* than Variant B. (see Figure 36, where reasons for choosing the first visual identity (Variant A) are shown).

Figure 36 Answers for an open-ended question in the fifth section

Why do you prefer this visual identity?

You can answer in either English or Czech.

24 responses

Overall design of A looks more pleasant and catching than in B
Suits the decision of a modern self-portrait studio, reflects its characteristics
2nd is boring
It's just the perfect variant that fits the company description
Despite the fact that bright colors in design are becoming less popular, I like the contrast and how the elements suite each other
Bright colours, trendy design
modern, more visually appealing (the second one looks a bit outdated)
I'm young, I like colors and it is closer to my view of good design. The B looks good but for age group women 40+

Note. Data collected from the author's primary questionnaire conducted in March 2025.

Descriptions like “*modern and visually appealing*,” “*bold and trendy*,” and “*more pleasant and catching than B*” underline the way Variant A resonates with the expectations of a contemporary, urban audience. One participant even pointed out generational differences, mentioning that Variant B might be better suited for “women 40+,” whereas Variant A matches the preferences of a younger audience (see other open-ended answers in the Appendix A).

Several respondents also wrote about the emotional alignment between the studio's intended personality and the chosen design. Descriptions like “modern and visually appealing,” “bold and trendy,” and “more pleasant and catching than B” underline the way Variant A resonates with the expectations of a contemporary, urban audience. One participant even pointed out generational differences, mentioning that Variant B might be better suited for “women 40+,” whereas Variant A matches the preferences of a younger, trend-conscious audience (find other open-ended answers in the Appendix A).

Finally, the open comments once again proved that Variant A is not only perceived as aesthetically better but is also seen as more engaging and suitable for a brand with the given description. Participants expressed confidence that this identity would successfully attract attention on Instagram, align with the modern self-portrait studio concept, and appeal to potential customers.

Section 5 supports the overall success of Variant A in connecting emotionally and visually with the target audience. These insights prove the idea that a vibrant and bold visual identity is the most suitable variant for Narcis Studio.

8.2 Follow-up questionnaire overview

To deepen the understanding of how memorable the visual identities were, a follow-up questionnaire was sent to participants who had agreed to be contacted further (after 48 hours of filling in the first questionnaire) and provided their emails. In total, 17 participants responded with open-ended answers. This follow-up questionnaire was important to addressing the first research question of this thesis: *Does a psychology-driven visual identity enhance brand recall more effectively than a non-strategic identity?*

The responses in the second questionnaire also provided strong support for the memorability and impact of Variant A. Participants consistently recalled details related to colors, typography, and logo design that were aligned with psychology-based principles applied in Variant A.

8.2.1 Key findings from the follow-up questionnaire

Here are the main findings that were gathered from the follow-up questionnaire that was fulfilled by 17 respondents (see their answers in Appendix B).

1. **Colors stood out the most.** The majority of respondents specifically remembered the bright and contrasting color palette, often mentioning combinations such as "*red, blue, green, and white.*" The high contrast was highlighted as a factor thanks to which the visuals appeared more eye-catching and memorable. This aligns with color psychology principles, where vibrant and contrasting colors increase visibility.
1. **Typography and logo recall.** Several respondents mentioned the bold, sans-serif typography, describing it as "clear," "readable," and "modern." Many also recalled the logo specifically, mentioning that the word "Narcis" appeared with unfinished letters, giving it a feeling of movement. This connects well with Gestalt principles such as closure, where the brain completes incomplete shapes, making them more engaging and memorable.
2. **Memorable graphic elements.** Beyond the basics of color and typography, participants recalled additional graphic details such as curvy lines, fluid shapes, and playful visual patterns. These elements contributed to a sense of movement, energy, and modernity, which participants found distinctive. One respondent specifically mentioned that the visuals "*didn't feel like a generic template*" but rather like a "*professional graphic designer's work.*"

3. **Emotional connection.** Respondents connected Variant A with feelings of fun, energy, creativity, and modernity, often stating that this aligned with their expectations for a self-portrait studio targeting young people. One participant mentioned, *“The brighter, bolder one stood out because it was more contrasting and closer to my age group (18-34).”* Others highlighted how the visual identity conveyed a message that was in line with the studio’s brand personality.
4. **Consistency with earlier results.** These follow-up answers strengthen earlier findings from Section 2 and 3 of the first questionnaire, where Variant A consistently outperformed Variant B in terms of emotional engagement, trustworthiness, and visual appeal. It demonstrates that the psychological design choices applied in Variant A contributed directly to stronger brand recall.

The follow-up questionnaire confirms that the psychology-based identity (Variant A) generated higher memorability among participants. The feedback suggests that usage of Gestalt principles, color psychology and target audience-oriented typography principles played a key role in making Variant A more recognizable and appealing. These findings directly answer the thesis' first research question (RQ1) and validate that psychology-driven design improves both recall and emotional connection.

8.3 Questionnaire limitations

While the questionnaire provided detailed insights into participants’ perceptions, it does have some limitations.

The sample size was relevant in terms of writing a bachelor thesis but still was limited to 95 people, which may not fully represent the whole target audience and its preferences.

Most participants were young adults with an interest in creative fields, which aligns with the brand’s target group but could potentially mean some bias in favor of bolder, more modern designs. Also, there were no questions about the cultural backgrounds, which could affect how certain colors, symbols, or aesthetics are perceived.

Also, since participants were aware they were comparing two identities, this direct comparison may have influenced their responses. Moreover, some of the respondents mentioned that in some questions they wanted to choose both variants and in some none but the questionnaire did not have these options.

Another limitation is that participants only interacted with the visual identities for a short period. Despite the fact that the follow-up questionnaire was sent to the respondents 48 hours after filling in the initial questionnaire, in real-world conditions brand exposure happens over a longer period and across different contexts, which can impact memorability and emotional engagement differently. While a follow-up questionnaire was conducted to assess brand recall, the number of respondents who answered was much lower than the number of people fulfilling the initial questionnaire (95 compared to 17), so the number of responses gathered from the follow-up questionnaire could be higher to provide more accurate results.

There is a probability that participants who chose to complete the survey may already have a stronger interest in design or branding, meaning their opinions could be more favorable or critical than the general audience.

9 Overall thesis limitations

Looking at the thesis as a whole, there are some broader limitations worth acknowledging. This thesis focused on a single case study – a self-portrait studio with specific positioning. It cannot be said for a 100% that the findings are directly applicable to other industries or brands with different target audiences.

Additionally, only two visual identities were tested. While they were designed in contrast, having more design variations could have revealed even more about what works and why. Lastly, deeper interviews and follow-ups with the respondents could have added more context to some of the answers given.

During the research process, no previous studies were found that tested two complete visual identities using both Instagram A/B testing and a detailed questionnaire, as done in this thesis. This made the thesis more original, but at the same time, it meant there weren't many academic sources or similar case studies to compare it with. It would be useful if future research explored a similar approach, as it could help confirm the findings and develop the method further.

10 Final synthesis and discussion

The goal of the practical part of this thesis was to test whether a psychology-based visual identity would lead to better results than a non-strategic one. Both the Instagram A/B testing and the questionnaire clearly showed that the psychology-based design (Variant A) performed better. This section reflects on what these results mean, why they might have happened, and how the two research methods support each other.

To better illustrate the differences between the psychology-based visual identity (Variant A) and the non-strategic visual identity (Variant B), the most important results from the A/B testing and the questionnaire are presented in the following table (see Table 1).

Table 1 Comparison of engagement and perception metric – Variant A and Variant B

Criteria	Variant A (Psychology based design)	Variant B (Non-psychology based design)	Difference/Conclusion
Profile Visits (Instagram)	306	116	+190 visits for A (+164%)
External Link Clicks (Instagram)	45	11	+34 clicks for A (+309%)
New Followers (Instagram)	31	5	+26 followers for A (+520%)
Reach (Instagram)	7,917	6,320	+1,579 users reached with A
Story Views (Instagram)	12,481	10,744	+1,737 views for A
Trust Rating (Survey)	80% rated 4–5	Majority rated 1–2	A rated as significantly more trustworthy
Emotional Response (Creativity, Fun, Confidence)	95–98% selected	Less than 30% selected	Stronger emotional connection with A
Memorability (Logo & Design)	94% preferred	6% preferred	A perceived as significantly more memorable
Willingness to Book/Follow	91–94% preferred	6–9% preferred	A more likely to drive action
Overall impression (open-ended)	“Modern,” “bold,” “professional,” “creative,” “high- quality”	“Dull,” “flower shop-like,” “forgettable,” “boring”	A better reflects the studio’s intended personality

Note. Data collected from the author’s questionnaire and A/B testing on Instagram conducted in March 2025.

Interpretation of A/B testing results

The Instagram A/B test showed that Variant A achieved significantly higher engagement. It led to 164% more profile visits, 309% more link clicks, and 520% more new followers than Variant B. These results suggest that design decisions based on psychological principles helped the visual identity attract more attention and encouraged users to interact with the ad.

This can be explained by several design choices. The color palette in Variant A used bright and contrasting colors, which helped the ad stand out and made it easier to notice. The bold typography improved readability, and the logo followed Gestalt principles like closure, continuity, and figure-ground contrast. These principles are known to support visual recognition and memorability, which is especially important on a platform like Instagram where users scroll quickly.

Variant B, in contrast, used muted colors, low contrast, serif fonts, and more decorative elements. While not necessarily “bad” design, this version did not align with the studio’s values of creativity, energy, and self-expression and was not based on psychological perception. Instead, it gave the impression of a more traditional or nature-inspired brand, which was not the intended positioning.

Comparison of Instagram ads and questionnaire results

The questionnaire results supported the findings from the Instagram test. While the A/B testing provided data on user behavior, the questionnaire offered insights about how people felt about each identity and why they preferred one over another. Most respondents described Variant A as more modern, trustworthy, and emotionally engaging. They also associated it with emotions like confidence, creativity, and fun – which were the brand’s intended values.

Together, these two research methods provide a more complete picture. The fact that both methods pointed to the same result increases the reliability of the findings.

Connection of the findings with the theoretical part

The results of this thesis are consistent with existing theories in the field of design psychology. The psychology-based visual identity, which incorporated emotionally resonant color schemes and Gestalt logo principles, led to significantly higher engagement and more positive brand perception. This outcome supports previous findings by Labrecque and Milne (2012), who highlighted the strong influence of color on trust and excitement in branding.

Similarly, the higher memorability of the psychology-based logo reflects the principles described by Henderson and Cote (1998), who emphasized that logos designed with clear structure and Gestalt rules are easier for audiences to remember. The emotional responses measured through the questionnaire also align with Boyatzis and Varghese's (1994) research, where specific colors were linked to predictable specific emotional reactions.

Overall, the findings reinforce the idea that psychology-informed design elements can significantly enhance both emotional connection and consumer behavior, confirming the

information from the theoretical part of the thesis. Future research could explore whether different demographic groups show similar or different reactions to the same psychological design strategies.

Research limitations and reflections

Like any research, this study has several limitations that should be considered.

Sample size and testing period: The questionnaire was completed by 95 people, and the Instagram ads ran for 15 days. These are reasonable numbers for a bachelor thesis, but larger samples and longer testing could lead to even more reliable results.

Instagram algorithm: Although both ads were published with the same budget, duration, and targeting settings, it is possible that Instagram's algorithm did not distribute them completely equally. This could have affected performance.

Overlap in audience: Some users might have seen both versions of the ad. This could have influenced their responses, especially if they compared the two consciously or unconsciously.

Researcher bias: Since I was both the designer of the visual identities and the person analyzing the results, there is a risk of bias. I did my best to approach both designs objectively and followed the same process for both. However, this should be mentioned as a possible limitation.

Not completely realistic Variant B: This variant was deliberately designed to illustrate how a visual identity might look when psychological principles are completely ignored. The goal was not to create a balanced design comparison, but rather to show an exaggerated contrast, a “what not to do” example. While this helped clearly highlight the advantages of a psychology-based approach, it also means that Variant B does not represent a realistic or competitive branding solution. In future research, it might be more useful to compare more realistic alternative variants of a visual identity.

11 Practical value of the thesis

Despite the limitations, this thesis offers valuable insights for brands and businesses. It shows that applying psychological principles – like applying color theory, following Gestalt principles, making typography choices tailored to the specific audience traits, can make a brand not only more visually appealing but also more memorable, engaging, and trustworthy. In a digital space, where people make decisions in seconds, often based on visual impressions, this kind of design thinking can have a big impact. Businesses that invest in strategically crafted visual identities are more likely to connect with their audience and turn engagement into real action, whether it's a follow, a booking, or a purchase.

12 Suggestions for further work

This research has potential for further exploration. Future studies could include a wider range of industries to see how psychology-based design works across different brand types.

It would also be useful to test more variations of visual identity elements, like different logo shapes or more subtle typography changes, to understand which psychological tools have the strongest impact.

Another interesting idea would be to combine A/B testing with user interviews, giving both behavioral data and deeper insights into consumer reasoning.

Finally, it could be valuable to track long-term engagement to see if the impact of psychology-based design continues over time, not just in the first interaction.

13 A practical guide for companies on applying psychology in branding

This thesis has shown that using psychological principles in visual identity design leads to stronger engagement, trust, and emotional connection with customers. To help companies benefit from these findings, this chapter introduces a simple framework for applying psychology when developing a brand identity. It is designed for business owners, marketers, or anyone involved in shaping how a brand looks and feels – even without design experience.

Step 1: Define how you the customers should feel

Before choosing any visual elements, clarify what kind of emotional response the brand should create. Should people feel confident and energized or maybe calm and valued?

These emotions will become the foundation for the visual identity.

Step 2: Understand the audience's expectations

Different audiences respond to different styles. A young, creative audience may expect bold visuals and informal fonts, while a more professional audience may trust calmer, more minimal visuals. Consider age, lifestyle and values.

Step 3: Choose brand colors intentionally

Color is not just about aesthetics – it affects how people feel about your brand. Use color psychology, for example:

Blue – trust, reliability

Red – energy, passion

Green – balance, nature

Yellow – optimism, friendliness

Make sure your color choices support the emotion you want to evoke not just what "looks nice." But the color also depends on its hue and the combination with the other colors. It is better to test the selected palette with your potential audience and ask them what emotions the chosen colors evoke.

Step 4: Choose typography that matches your brand tone

Typography gives your brand a voice. For example, modern sans-serif fonts feel clean and bold, while serif fonts feel more classic and traditional. A good question to be asked: *Does this font reflect the message and personality of my business?*

Step 5: Use basic visual psychology when creating a logo

Effective logos are not just creative – they are easy to understand and remember. The best ones often use visual psychology principles, such as simplicity, contrast, and balance. These make it easier for people to recognize and trust your brand at a glance.

13.1 Checklist for businesses. How to apply psychology in a visual identity

This checklist is designed to help businesses apply key psychological principles when creating or evaluating their brand identity. It offers simple steps to ensure that your visual branding is not only attractive, but also emotionally effective and aligned with your target audience.

1. Brand Strategy

Connecting brand goals, emotional message, and personality with the visual look.

- Have we defined the main feelings we want our brand to evoke?
- Have we clearly described our brand personality (for example fun, elegant, modern)?
- Does our team agree on how the brand should look and feel?
- Is the visual identity aligned with our brand promise and customer experience?

2. Audience Alignment

Understanding and matching the expectations of the target audience.

- Do we understand our target audience's lifestyle, values, and expectations?
- Have we checked what types of visuals our audience engages with (for example on social media)?
- Would our target audience likely say: "This brand looks like it was made for me"?

3. Visual Psychology

Creating main visual identity elements (color, typography, logo) based on cognitive and emotional impact.

- Do our colors reflect the emotions we want to evoke?
- Do our color choices avoid conflicting emotional signals?
- Have we considered cultural meanings of colors (if our audience is international)?
- Does our typography match the brand tone?
- Is our logo designed using psychological principles (e.g., closure, contrast)?

4. Practical Execution

Proving readability, consistency, and functionality of the created visual identity.

- Is our typography readable on screens and in print?
- Is our logo easy to recognize at a small size (for example on a profile picture)?
- Do all visual elements feel visually consistent across platforms?

A print-ready version of the checklist is included in Appendix C.

Conclusions

The goal of this thesis was to find out whether a psychology-based visual identity can improve how a brand is perceived and how people engage with it — compared to a visual identity that doesn't follow any strategic or psychological design principles.

The theoretical part focused on visual identity, an important part of branding, and how design elements like color, typography, and logos influence perception and emotions. It also looked at platforms like Instagram and the role of A/B testing in evaluating visual identities. This foundation helped to create the two contrasting visual identities for the self-portrait studio and guided the testing methods used later in the research.

In the practical part, these two visual identities for the self-portrait studio Narcis were created and tested using A/B testing on Instagram ads and a detailed questionnaire created for the target audience of the studio. The results from both methods clearly showed that the psychology-based identity (Variant A) consistently outperformed the alternative.

The Instagram A/B testing answered RQ4: the ad using the psychology-based visual identity had significantly higher engagement. It brought in more profile visits, external link clicks, and followers. This suggests that using color theory, contrast, and strong typography does help catch people's attention and turn it into action.

In the questionnaire, the participants remembered Variant A more easily, both right after seeing it and in the follow-up survey, confirming its stronger brand recall compared to the Variant B (RQ1). Respondents also connected Variant A with key intended emotions like creativity, excitement, and confidence and chose Variant A is more trustworthy — proving that the color palette and typography pairings influenced their emotional response and trust (RQ3). When asked why the logo was more memorable, most people pointed out Gestalt principles like contrast, visual hierarchy, unity, and simplicity, helping answer RQ2 as well.

Finally, both the questionnaire and open-ended feedback showed that Variant A didn't just look better — it felt better. People said it looked more professional, modern, and more in line with what they expect from a creative studio aimed at younger audiences. This stronger emotional connection and interaction helps answer RQ5.

The findings of this thesis show that using psychological principles in visual identity design can make a difference. Brands that want to connect better with their audience should choose colors that match the feelings they want to evoke, use typography that fits their message, and design logos that are easy to remember.

The practical checklist created in this thesis gives businesses easy steps to follow when designing or updating their visual identity. By applying these guidelines carefully and consistently, companies can make their brand communication stronger and more effective.

In the future, it would be interesting to test how psychological design principles work in different industries or cultural settings. It could also be useful to run longer campaigns to see how psychology-based visual identities influence brand loyalty over time.

This thesis also adds value to the academic field by showing a way to test visual identities using both real online behavior and feedback from the questionnaire. Future research could apply the same method to other industries, platforms, or age groups, or explore which design elements have the biggest effect on people's emotions and behavior.

Overall, this thesis shows that psychology is a useful tool for making branding more effective — and that well-designed visuals can lead to stronger emotional connections and better results for brands.

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Appendices

Appendix A – First Questionnaire

*all of the answers were given in English and were not translated or corrected

Section 1

What is your age group?

- Under 18
- 18-34
- 35 and older

How would you describe the size of the place you live in?

- Large city (100,000+ inhabitants)
- Medium-sized city (20,000–99,999 inhabitants)
- Small town (5,000–19,999 inhabitants)
- Village or small municipality (less than 5,000 inhabitants)

Do you have any previous experience with photography or design?

- Yes, professionally
- Yes, as a hobby
- A little
- None

How do you prefer to spend your disposable income? (Select all that apply)

- Traveling and new experiences
- Dining out and socializing
- Photography, art, or creative hobbies
- Fashion and personal style
- Technology and gadgets
- Health, wellness, and fitness
- Saving and financial investments

Other: -

How much does the visual identity (logo, colors, typography, and overall design) of a brand influence your decision to choose a service or product?

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (“Not at all”) to 5 (“Very much”).

If two similar brands offer the same product/service at the same price and location, but one of them has a well-made visual identity and the other is not, would it influence your choice?

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

If you were choosing a self-portrait studio, would the branding influence your decision to book a session?

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

Is there anything else that comes to your mind regarding this section that you would like to share?

Open question.

Respondents' answers: -

Section 2

Which visual identity is more memorable at first glance?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity do you believe would appeal to you even after extended use?

- Variant A
- Variant B

What associations does the first visual identity (Variant A) evoke? (Select all that apply)

- Flowers
- Nature
- Elegance
- Self-love
- Confidence
- Creativity
- Fun

Other: -

What associations does the first visual identity (Variant B) evoke? (Select all that apply)

- Flowers
- Nature
- Elegance
- Self-love
- Confidence
- Creativity
- Fun

Other: -

Which visual identity better evokes the emotions of excitement?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity better evokes the emotions of confidence?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity better evokes the emotions of creativity?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which logo seems more memorable?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which logo is more readable and eye-pleasing?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Why do you find the chosen logo memorable?

- Simplicity
- Symmetry
- Visual hierarchy
- Contrast
- Repetition
- Unity

Other: -

Which color palette is more suitable for a modern self-portrait studio that wants to be perceived as bright and bold?

- Variant A
- Variant B

On a scale of 1-5, how much do you trust each brand based on its color scheme? (Variant A)

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

On a scale of 1-5, how much do you trust each brand based on its color scheme? (Variant B)

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

Which typography pairing is more appropriate for a modern self-portrait studio that wants to be perceived as bright and bold?

- Variant A
- Variant B

On a scale of 1-5, how the typography of the visual identity (Variant A) impacts your perception of the brand's credibility?

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

On a scale of 1-5, how the typography of the visual identity (Variant B) impacts your perception of the brand's credibility?

A 5-point Likert scale ranging from 1 ("Not at all") to 5 ("Very much").

Is there anything else that comes to your mind regarding this section that you would like to share?

Open question.

Respondents' answers: -

Section 3

Which visual identity is more modern?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which brand identity feels more aligned with a modern self-portrait studio that wants to be perceived as bright and bold?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity gives you a stronger emotional connection?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity feels more readable and clear?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which color evokes emotions that fit that self-portrait studio?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity do you find trustworthy?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Why do you find the chosen visual identity trustworthy?

Open question.

Respondents' answers:

- *It is made precisely, with an attention to details and illustrating brand message*
- *It looks like a graphic designer's work, not some generic pinterest/canva template.*
- *It caught my attention. I love the creative approach, she stands out from her competitors.*
- *It is done precisely, if a brand cares about the visual details it probably cares about everything else*
- *Because of typography and chosen colors of design - looks unique, bright and eye-catching*
- *bright, interesting, modern*

- *Well made graphics that suits the brand positioning well*
- *Colors reflect calmness*
- *It reflects the positioning of this studio visually, while the variant B is about something else - I get vibes of an old-fashioned flowers studio and the second design lacks contrast, which is really important for grabbing the attention quickly*
- *Simplicity and human made*
- *Depicts bright colors and nice typography which fits the image of a photo-studio*
- *Done according to the brand message, so by the visual expression I know that to expect from the studio*
- *The second one (Variant B) doesn't reflect the studio description, while the first one (Variant A) successfully does*
- *I just feel that Variant A is more suitable for this studio*

Is there anything else that comes to your mind regarding this section that you would like to share?

Open question.

Respondents' answers: -

Section 4

Which visual identity would you be more likely to follow on Instagram?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity's Instagram content feels more engaging and visually compelling?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Which visual identity would make you more likely to book a session at the studio?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Is there anything else that comes to your mind regarding this section that you would like to share?

Open question.

Respondents' answers: -

Section 5

Which visual identity do you prefer overall?

- Variant A
- Variant B

Why do you prefer this visual identity?

Open question.

Respondents' answers:

- *It looks like a graphic designer's work, not some generic pinterest/canva template.*
- *Bright, clear and creative*
- *It corresponds with the message of the studio better*
- *calm colors that do not cause irritation, i feel responsible, calm, comfortable*
- *Overall design of A looks more pleasant and catching than in B*
- *Suits the decision of a modern self-portrait studio, reflects its characteristics*
- *2nd is boring*
- *It's just the perfect variant that fits the company description*
- *Despite the fact that bright colors in design are becoming less popular, I like the contrast and how the elements suite each other*
- *Bright colours, trendy design*
- *modern, more visually appealing (the second one looks a bit outdated)*
- *I'm young, I like colors and it is closer to my view of good design. The B looks good but for age group women 40+*
- *Memorable and fun*
- *Catchy, bolder, And much more readable fonts*
- *Because of the bright colours, strong and bold visual identity*
- *It's fresh, modern, bold and stylish, which is what I want to see these days. I love when brands put effort into making their visual identity stand out and appeal to me and it's what v.A feels like.*
- *Variant A seems more suitable for extravert people, Variant B seems more suitable for introvert people.*
- *It attracts me more*
- *variant A looks more modern and visually understandable*
- *It gives the emotions of something bright, funny, modern - the exact feelings the studio wants to be associated with*
- *It suits this studio, looks 10/10*
- *More modern and interesting*

What aspects of the preferred brand identity stood out to you the most?

- Colors
- Typography
- Logo
- Overall aesthetic
- Emotional appeal

Other: -

Why do you prefer these aspects?

Open question.

Respondents' answers:

- *They suit the studio description*
- *This visual caught my attention from the first seconds with its brightness and evoked emotions.*
- *They are nicely made*
- *More organized*
- *Emotional appeal is different to everyone but other things are definitely attractive*
- *Look unusual, brings, grab attention*
- *A like the uniqueness*
- *Colors Draw attention*
- *it has greater connection with the studio name*
- *They are done well, I like this design*
- *They are precisely created, reflecting the studio core values*
- *Because it is the emotions evoked by the identity that can attract the consumer's gaze, and the number of customers of the brand depends on the quality of the identity and the emotions evoked.*

What emotions does the preferred visual identity it evoke?

- Confidence
- Excitement
- Creativity
- Freedom
- Fun

Other: -

Do you have any other comments or suggestions about the visual identities presented?

Open question.

Respondents' answers:

- *I would like to know when this studio will open.*
- *I really like the visual identity A, I think there is nothing to add or to change*
- *I would advice the studio to choose the Variant A*
- *Excellent work was done on A identity, nothing to add*
- *I would recommend to use the visual identity A, as a graphic designer I see a lot of potential in this variant*

Appendix B – Follow-up questionnaire

*all of the answers were given in English and were not translated or corrected

Without referring back to the initial survey, please describe any details you can recall about the visual identity that was more appealing to you. (Please, include elements like logo, color scheme, and typography)

Open question.

Respondents' answers:

- *I remember a vibrant red color paired with a crisp white. The logo was simple but bold in a sans-serif font*
- *colors (and they mixed with each others and make the overall impression more interesting) graphic elements, typography*
- *Modern visual identity, bright colors (red, blue, green, white), Narcis in the logo with not fully finished letters - I liked this effect*
- *I remember colors - blue, green, red, white. Logo was a name "Narcis" written using an interesting font. Typography was readable and clear*
- *The typography was modern and the use of bold and regular fonts helped highlight certain words, making the overall design impactful*
- *Green, Red, Blue colors. Bright identity, clear and readable logo with an interesting font*
- *Colors, fonts and overall bright visuals for the more fun one.*
- *Colors - red, blue, yellow. Logo - name "Narcis" with not fully finished letters but the idea is interesting - it gives motion. Typography - readable, clear*
- *The identity had some graphical elements that looked like waves or fluid shapes in red and blue, which I thought were quite unique and eye-catching*
- *I liked the variant A better. I remember the high contrast and interesting colour combination - it was green, blue, orange and white. Also I remember curvy lines on Instagram greed. The logo was bright green on the blue background. The typefaces were sans serif, readable and clear. Overall look was very catchy, energetic, modern and I think suit the message the studio wants to convey really well.*
- *Logo - Green "Narcis" of the blue background, clear typography, colors - red, blue, green, white*
- *I recall high contrast, vibrant colors, nicely looking Instagram greed that definitely cathe attention*
- *I remember colors, as they were very vibrant, and shapes - bouncy and dynamic. Also there was a portrait picture of a person, which I liked, because it feels less artificial and made up when there are photos and not only graphics, especially not edited kinda raw photos.*
- *Red and other vivid colours, funky font, bold design pattern*
- *Bright colours, readable typography, nice logo*

- *I remember sans-serif typefaces, an interesting one was used for logo and the letters were not fully finished but it gave the overall identity the feeling of motion and energy. The colors were bright*
- *Details that stand out to me include the playful arrangement of text and graphics which made the design dynamic and engaging*

Which visual identity did you feel a stronger emotional connection with and why? (Please, mention any specific design elements that contribute to this feeling if you remember any)

Open question.

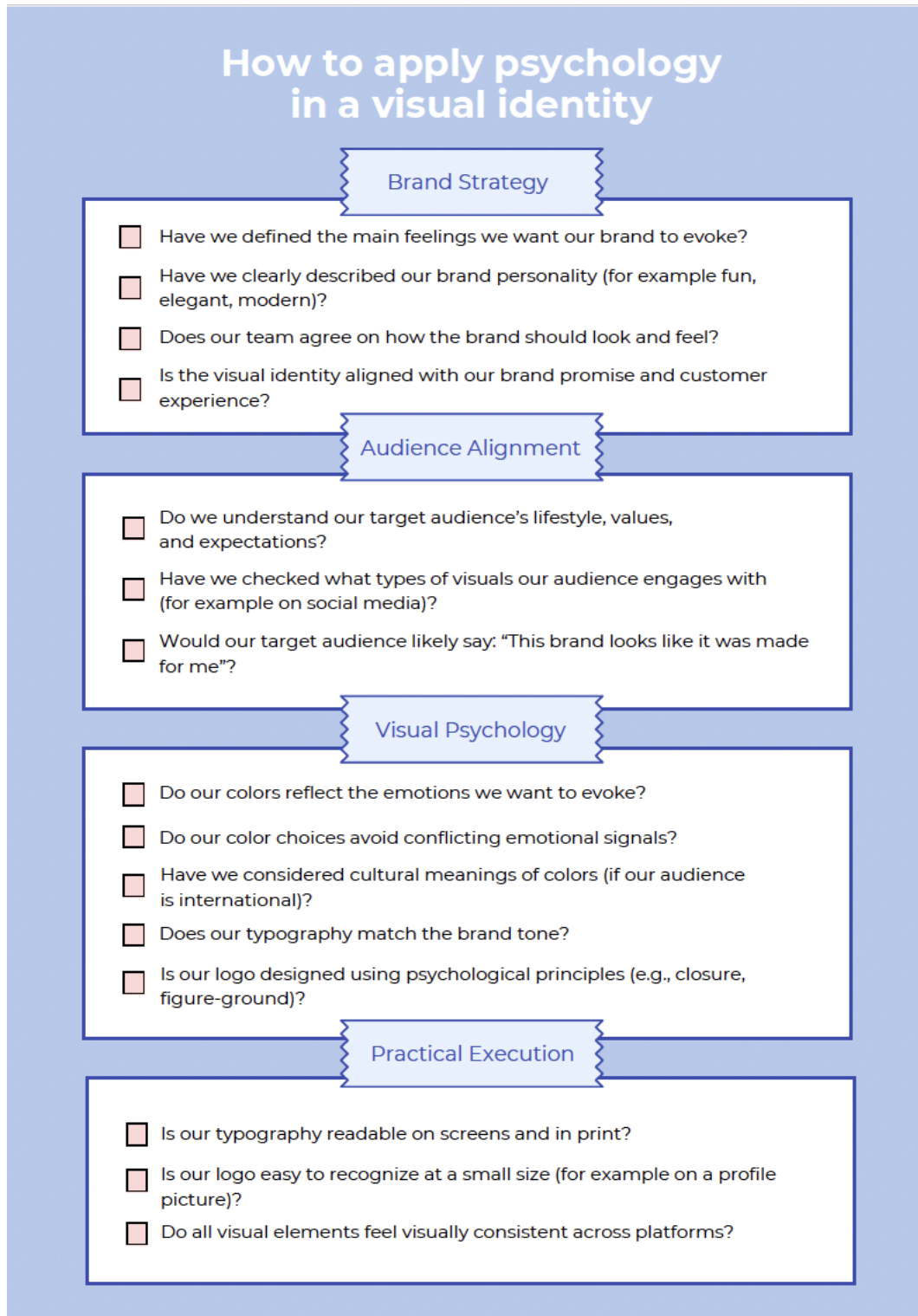
Respondents' answers:

- *I felt a stronger connection with the design that used the red and white color scheme. The contrast was striking, and it made the text stand out, making it memorable*
- *combination of colors and typography makes me feel that the studio is modern and i can trust them*
- *Variant A - modern, bold, bright, interesting*
- *I liked variant A. It's vibrant colors and young look stood out the most for me.*
- *The playful graphics and curves in the background of some images gave a sense of fun and creativity that really spoke to me*
- *With the variant A, it suits this studio better and I also like to spend time discovering new things like going to self-portrait studios*
- *the brighter, more bold one, because it was more contrasting and closer to my age group liking i think (18-34)*
- *Variant A*
- *I was drawn to the design that featured bold, sans-serif typography. It feels modern and straightforward, which I find very appealing*
- *Variant A definitely. I like the overall feeling of movement and energy - it caught my attention - curvy lines, people in movement. Also I liked how the logo was made - letters were not finished fully there were some spaces but overall look appeared finished and also moving. Since I am the target audience of this studio, I would like to go there and try self-portrait photo shoot mainly because of this design because I expect the studio to give the same vibe - energetic, fun, creative and modern*
- *I remember that the identical I didn't like didn't have constant and any interesting elements at all - it had a vibe of an old-fashioned flower shop. While in contrast Variant A was bright, vivid and energetic, so since I am the target audience I think the design reached its goal to be fun, bold, creative and modern*
- *With Variant A, it just matches the message the studio wants to communicate very well*
- *I liked the 1 one (colourful) more because I could feel that it has a potential to become something unique and would eventually appeal to me in real life if I just randomly saw it on Ig.*
- *The bolder colour palette is more eye-catching, the other design was too grounded evoking slightly more something like planting trees than photo studio*

- *Variant A*
- *It felt modern and energetic*
- *With variant A - i liked the colors and the overall vibe*

Appendix C – How to apply psychology in a visual identity

Figure 337 How to apply psychology in a visual identity



(Kosheleva, 2025)